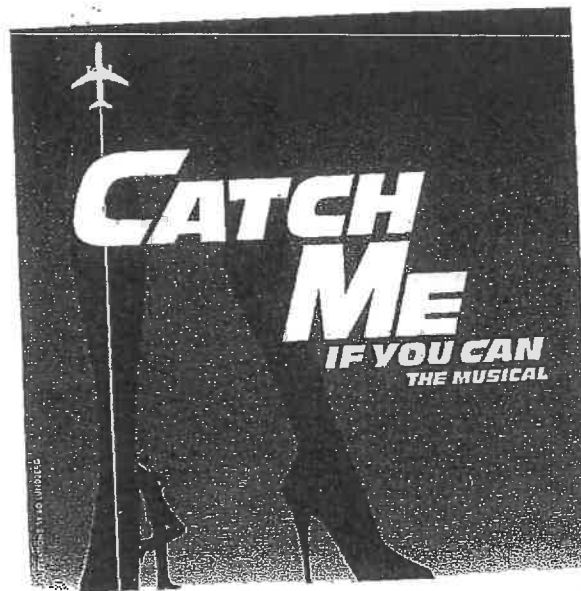


LIBRETTO VOCAL BOOK



Based on the DreamWorks Motion Picture

Book by
Terrence McNally

Music by
Marc Shaiman

Lyrics by
Scott Wittman
and **Marc Shaiman**

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CHARACTERS

FRANK ABAGNALE, JR.

CARL HANRATTY

FRANK ABAGNALE, SR.

PAULA ABAGNALE

BRENDA STRONG

CAROL STRONG

ROGER STRONG

CHERYL ANN

AGENT BRANTON

AGENT COD

AGENT DOLLAR

ENSEMBLE:

JACK BARNES, NERD, JOCK, PRICIPAL, BETTY, JUDGE,
COMMUTERS, RAILROAD AGENT, ASSISTANTS,
BANK TELLER, PAN AM EXECUTIVE, TAILOR,
STEWARDESSES (Mindy, Cindy, Lindy, Jane, Kellie, Shellie),
PILOTS, AGENTS, TARGETS, MOTEL MANAGER,
PARTY-GOERS, DOCTORS, NURSES, INTERNS,
DOCTOR WANAMAKER, BAR TENDER, BEN CASEY,
BEN CASEY INTERN, *etc.*

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ACT ONE**Prologue**

(In darkness, we hear the very loud sound of a jet taking off just overhead.)

Lights up on a gate area at Miami International Airport - circa 1960s.

ANNOUNCEMENTS murmur throughout. Courtesy phones, pages for passengers, calls, for specific airlines and flights, mentioning long-gone airlines like TWA, Braniff, and Pan Am.

At center stands a young woman (BRENDA STRONG) looking around. She seems anxious - like she's looking for someone. Several passengers mill about and a few stewardesses cross through on their way to the gate. A man (FRANK ABAGNALE JR) is seated on a bench up right. He is hidden, reading a newspaper. Announcements are heard. A man in a black suit (AGENT BRANTON) shuffles through in a hurry. He nods to Brenda, she hesitates and then moves towards him. Suddenly, we hear a loud door slam off right. A pilot runs through from right to left followed by three FBI agents (COD, DOLLAR and CARL HANRATTY). HANRATTY pauses to catch his breath and continues off. As they pass, FRANK JR lowers the newspaper and reveals himself. Cautiously he folds the paper, stands up, picks up his suitcase and starts to move downstage.

CARL HANRATTY re-appears. He points to FRANK JR and yells.)

BRANTON

There he is.

DOLLAR

Stop or I'll shoot.

HANRATTY

God Dangit! It's him. There he is! He's not giving me the slip this time! God dang it. Excuse me, sir...There he is.

(CARL HANRATTY re-appears. He points to FRANK JR and yells.

FRANK JR crosses up left behind a group of huddled bystanders. DOLLAR enters followed by COD.)

COD

(overlapping)

Hold it right there.

DOLLAR

(overlapping)

Don't move. I will shoot, I will shoot.

CATCH ME IF YOU CAN

BRANTON

(overlapping)

Freeze.

HANRATTY

Hold it, Frank. Freeze! Stop where you are.

DOLLAR

I'm gonna shoot!

(A deafening SHOT stops everyone in their tracks. Frank Jr drops the suitcase which opens to reveal that it's stacked full with \$\$\$. The Passengers all stop and stare.)

FRANK JUNIOR

That was close! You could hurt someone.

HANRATTY

Come on, Frank. I'd rather take you alive than dead.

FRANK JUNIOR

Can I at least make a statement first?

HANRATTY

At the airport? No.

FRANK JUNIOR

I'm sure these people want to know why you're shooting at me.

(Looks to them: they kind of do)

I think they should know who I am and what I did and why I did it.

HANRATTY

This is one of your tricks. Men!

(Jerks his head to the Agents, who close in)

You're not going to fool me again, like you did in that hotel room in L.A. You're not putting on a show for these people.

FRANK JUNIOR

A show?

#1 - Live In Living Color

*(MUSIC: A figure from the orchestra - we'll call it our STINGER.
Frank Junior looks at us and smiles)*

A show.

(Frank Junior snaps his fingers.

MUSIC CONTINUES with a huge timpani roll.

A sudden reveal shows a lavish backdrop and tuxedoed ORCHESTRA on a jazzy bandstand.)

(FRANK JUNIOR)

We need some lights.

(He waves his arm. Lights change.)

COD

The hell is he doing?

HANRATTY

Misdirection, it's the technique.

FRANK JUNIOR

Cameras. And the Frank Abagnale Junior Orchestral

(He waves to the Orchestra, the CONDUCTOR acknowledges, and launches into the song proper.)

HANRATTY

Frank, what the hell are you doing? Branton, Cod, get everyone out of here.

(As the other agents hurry the passengers to the exits, Hanratty edges upstage to check out the orchestra, keeping his gun on Frank Junior...

...who crosses downstage to us.)

FRANK JUNIOR

My name is Frank William Abagnale...Junior. This is my story.

HANRATTY

These people have musical instruments.

FRANK JUNIOR

I was a millionaire twice over and half again before I was twenty-one. I stole every nickel of it. I flew over five million miles as a Pan Am pilot, practiced medicine at a top Atlanta hospital, and worked as a prosecutor for the State of Louisiana, all under assumed names. Mister Hanratty thinks he has all the facts, but only I know just how I did it. And I did it in style.

(He sings to us. As he does, Hanratty comes downstage and notices us, and tries not to be too unsettled.)

LIVE IN LIVING COLOR

LET ME TAKE YOU FOR A RIDE

(FRANK JUNIOR)

YES, I'M LIVE IN LIVING COLOR
SO SIT BACK AND LET ME BE
YOUR T.V. GUIDE!

(The groove kicks in. Hanratty points the gun at Frank Junior.)

HANRATTY

You think your life is a T.V. special?

FRANK JUNIOR

Modesty has never been one of my virtues.

HANRATTY

Virtue has never been one of your virtues.

FRANK JUNIOR

(sings)

I GOTTA STORY I'D LIKE TO TELL
BUT I'M GONNA NEED HELP TO TELL IT WELL
I GOTTA STORY 'BOUT FAME AND MONEY
AND IT'S GOT MORE CURVES THAN A PLAYBOY BUNNY
I WANNA LIVE NOT JUST SURVIVE
I WANNA TELL MY STORY LIVE
AND IN LIVING COLOR!

(The ENSEMBLE enter, and Hanratty finds himself surrounded by dancing bodies...)

ENSEMBLE

(on Frank Junior's "color")

LIVE IN LIVING COLOR

HANRATTY

For the love of—

(...and he ducks and fights his way out to one side, as Frank Junior continues.)

FRANK JUNIOR

SOMETHING SPECIAL'S UP TONIGHT
YES I'M

FRANK JUNIOR + ENSEMBLE

LIVE IN LIVING COLOR

FRANK JUNIOR

LIFE AIN'T LIVED IN BLACK AND WHITE!

(speaks)

Ladies and gentlemen, the Frank Abagnale Junior Singers and Dancers!

(Hanratty fights his way through the Frank Abagnale Junior Singers and Dancers and speaks to us.)

HANRATTY

Enough! Folks, listen, by the time this guy was 20 years old, he had stolen more than one-point-eight million dollars. He's a con man, plain and simple. Has been since the age of 16, when he bilked 20 grand from his father's Mobil card to buy presents for girls. When he got caught his only excuse was—

FRANK JUNIOR

I like girls.

HANRATTY

Tell the folks how "I like girls" becomes "I'm wanted on five continents."
Your ability to pull myth from manure is truly impressive.

FRANK JUNIOR

Thank you!

FRANK JUNIOR & ENSEMBLE

LIVE IN LIVING COLOR

FRANK JUNIOR

AND IT'S BROUGHT TO YOU BY ME
YES IT'S

FRANK JUNIOR & ENSEMBLE

LIVE IN LIVING COLOR

FRANK JUNIOR

THIS WON'T FIT IN YOUR T.V.!

(speaks)

My parents, Frank and Paula Abagnale!

(MUSIC CHANGES.)

FRANK SENIOR and PAULA enter in a sweep, and begin to dance together, beautifully. Stunning and romantic.)

My parents met in France. A little village called Montrichard. After the war. My dad was a GI. My mother was young and beautiful.

FRANK SENIOR

(To us)

The people in that little French village were so happy to see Americans that they decided to put on a show for us. So they crammed two hundred GI's into a tiny social hall and the first person to walk on stage is your mother, and she starts to dance...The men are literally holding their breath. And I turned to my buddies and I said—

FRANK SENIOR + FRANK JUNIOR

—I am not leaving France without that woman.

PAULA

I always get into trouble when I dance with you.

(They dance. Frank Junior watches.)

FRANK JUNIOR

I could watch them dance all night.

(Hanratty steps in.)

HANRATTY

[continuing as needed]

Frank, come on, I interviewed both your parents, don't try to sell me [some sentimental picture of domestic bliss]—

(Frank Junior plows forth as MUSIC CHANGES.

Frank Senior sweeps Paula off her feet, and they dance off.)

FRANK JUNIOR

With a special guest appearance by Playboy's Playmate of the Year, Cheryl Ann...Something!

(Lights on CHERYL ANN, who's pissed.)

CHERYL ANN

I'm surprised you even remembered my *first* name. Listen, you no good sonofabitch—

FRANK JUNIOR

Thank you, Cheryl Ann!

(Hanratty has had enough.)

HANRATTY

All right, Frank. That's enough. I know the story and I'm taking you in.

FRANK JUNIOR

Alright Mr. Hanratty I'll make you a deal. You let me finish, and I'll tell you everything. I'll even tell you how I passed the bar exam in New Orleans. We owe each other that much, don'tcha think? Mr. Hanratty?

HANRATTY

Okay, you got a deal.

FRANK JUNIOR

You're gonna love it, Carl.

HANRATTY

I'll be the judge of that, Frank. Or whatever you're calling yourself today! Frank Williams! Frank Taylor! William Franklin Williams!

FRANK JUNIOR

WHAT'S A NAME?

JUST WINDOW DRESSING

EVERYBODY KNOWS THAT IT'S
CLOTHES THAT MAKE THE MAN

PLAY THEM GAME

JUST KEEP 'EM GUESSING

MIX AND MATCH ME
TRY TO CATCH ME IF YOU CAN

OH!

I GOTTA STORY THAT'S
STRANGE BUT TRUE

SO COME FLY WITH ME
FOR A BIRD'S-EYE VIEW

I'VE GOT THE WORLD
AT MY COMMAND

ENSEMBLE

SHOO-BEE DOO-WOP, BOP-BOP

SHOO-BEE DOO-WOP, BOP-BOP

CLOTHES THAT MAKE THE MAN

SHOO-BEE DOO-WOP, BOP-BOP

SHOO-BEE DOO-WOP, BOP-BOP

OH!

I GOTTA STORY THAT'S
STRANGE BUT TRUE

SO COME FLY WITH ME
FOR A BIRD'S-EYE VIEW

I'VE GOT THE WORLD
AT MY COMMAND

(FRANK JUNIOR)

AND I'LL BE YOUR ONE-MAN
DISNEYLAND

I DON'T WANT TO WAIT FOR
THE COPS TO ARRIVE
I WANNA TELL MY STORY LIVE
AND IN LIVING COLOR

TUNE ME IN AND TURN ME ON,
YES I'M
LIVE IN LIVING COLOR
BLINK YOUR EYES AND I'LL BE GONE
YES, I'M
LIVE IN LIVING COLOR
TUNE ME IN AND TURN ME ON,
YES I'M
LIVE IN LIVING COLOR
BLINK YOUR EYES

(ENSEMBLE)

AND I'LL BE YOUR ONE-MAN
DISNEYLAND

LIVE IN LIVING COLOR

LIVE IN LIVING COLOR

LIVE IN LIVING COLOR

LIVE IN LIVING COLOR

FRANK JUNIOR & MEN

BLINK YOUR EYES

FRANK JUNIOR

AND I'LL
BE GONE!

ENSEMBLE

BE GONE!

(SONG ENDS.

MUSIC begins again. The ensemble break their tableaux and dance in the background as Frank Junior - our host - speaks to us.)

#1a - Live In Living Color Tag

FRANK JUNIOR

Christmas Eve, 1964. A beautiful house on the best street in New Rochelle, New York. The house everyone wanted, and the family everyone wanted to be. The Abagnale home.

(Frank Junior goes, and the Ensemble comes forward - and set the stage for the Abagnale home.)

ENSEMBLE

LIVE IN LIVING COLOR
TUNE ME IN AND TURN ME ON
LIVE IN LIVING COLOR
BLINK YOUR EYES AND I'LL BE GONE

(As we complete the TRANSITION TO...)

Scene 1

Living Room, The Abagnale House, New Rochelle

(... and the dancers move to the background and then disappear.

Paula opens the Christmas Tree.

Frank Senior watches her.

Frank Junior is watching a small color television set, and the SINGERS fade from house speakers to the television set - they're on the show Frank Junior is watching.)

ENSEMBLE (ON TV)

LIVE IN LIVING COLOR...

FRANK JUNIOR

Dad, you were right. Everything is better in color.

FRANK SENIOR

How about that 13 inch screen?

FRANK JUNIOR

It's like Hullabaloo is right here in our living room!

#1b - Living Room TV Christmas

PAULA

But - so that I understand - you left this morning with a Cadillac and two hundred dollars and come home with a television and a used Ford?

FRANK SENIOR

Can I strike a bargain or what? I left those guys with their heads spinning.

PAULA

I think I know the feeling.

FRANK SENIOR

It's that Abagnale magic. C'mon - dance with me.

PAULA

Frank, I have dinner going -

(But she starts to dance with him. Frank Jr. is still with the television.)

FRANK SENIOR

Nothing's too good for my family.

PAULA

I hope you got the loan.

FRANK SENIOR

I wouldn't be dancing if I didn't.

FRANK JUNIOR

What did you tell them?

FRANK SENIOR

People only know what you tell them, Frankie. It's all a dance—swap the Caddy for the Ford, use the extra cash to pay the mortgage, use the mortgage to leverage the bank loan, use the loan to tide the business over until you can get the Caddy back. There's always another move to make.

PAULA

(pulls away)

I really should see to dinner.

(She goes.)

FRANK JUNIOR

You got the loan! That's great—

FRANK SENIOR

Shh. I didn't get the loan.

FRANK JUNIOR

What happened?

FRANK SENIOR

Ah, it's just a technicality. They won't loan to anyone under I.R.S. investigation.

FRANK JUNIOR

Oh.

FRANK SENIOR

Listen to me. You remember this story. Two little mice fell into a bucket of cream. The first mouse quickly gave up and drowned. The second mouse wouldn't quit. He struggled so hard that eventually he churned that cream into butter...

FRANK SENIOR and FRANK JUNIOR

...and he climbed out.

FRANK SENIOR

And who are we?

FRANK JUNIOR

We're the second mouse.

FRANK SENIOR

Damn straight we are. We're gonna be fine. As a matter of fact, you know what? We're going downtown to buy you your Christmas present. A brand new Botany 500 suit.

FRANK JUNIOR

Dad, that's too expensive.

FRANK SENIOR

Frankie. You know why the Yankees win all the time? It's not the Mick. It's not Joe Pepitone. It's the uniform.

(MUSIC.)

#2 - The Pinstripes Are All That They See

The other teams just stand there, staring at the pinstripes, mesmerized. Hell, they scared the Dodgers so much they left town.

WHEN YOUR MOTHER WALKED INTO
THAT DANCEHALL IN MONTRICHARD
WHAT DID SHE SEE?
THROUGH THE HAZE OF CHAMPAGNE
DID SHE NOTICE MY BRAIN
OR MY COLLEGE DEGREE?

KID, WHAT SHE SAW...WAS THE UNIFORM!
THROUGH THE DIRT AND DEBRIS
YES, THOSE LADIES GAVE THANKS
TO US VISITING YANKS
CAUSE THE PINSTripES ARE ALL THAT THEY SEE

(Frank Senior grabs a mic and takes the stage. He's joined by a bevy of BEAUTIFUL GIRLS in Yankee pinstripes.

Frank Junior comes downstage: our host.)

FRANK JUNIOR

(to us, pausing as needed)

Ladies and gentlemen, the smartest man I know. The man with all the moves, my dad - Frank...Abagnale...Senior!

FRANK SENIOR

WHEN A PILOT WALKS ONTO THE PLANE
ALL THE PASSENGERS SMILE AND RELAX

THUS WE W/ their life

BEAUTIFUL GIRLS

SMILE AND RELAX *trust with their wife*
SMILE AND RELAX

FRANK SENIOR

DO THEY SEE HE'S STILL TIGHT
FROM THE PARTY LAST NIGHT
AND THE BACK TO BACK "JACKS"?

*stayed up all night in a
fight w/ his wife?*

BEAUTIFUL GIRLS

STEWED TO THE MAX *fight his wife*

FRANK SENIOR

NO WHAT THEY SEE IS THE UNIFORM
HOW IT FITS TO A "T"
LIKE THE VISITING TEAM
THAT THE YANKEES WILL CREAM
THE PINSTRIPES ARE ALL THAT THEY SEE

*(The Beautiful Girls surround Frank Junior, and he emerges dressed smartly in his
prep-school blazer.)*

IF YOU WANNA BE A SOMEONE
CAN'T LOOK LIKE A BUM
A BOOK'S JUDGED BY ITS COVER
IS THE FIRST RULE OF THUMB

I WANNA WATCH YA TAKE OFF
STRAIGHT TO THE TOP FLOOR
SO START DRESSIN' TO IMPRESS 'EM
AND SON YOU'LL STROLL IN THE FRONT DOOR
A KID IN A MAN'S CANDY STORE...

(As Frank Junior speaks to us, Jack Barnes and Paula enter, not quite separately.

Jack goes to Frank Senior and shakes his hand. Paula comes to Frank Junior.

MUSIC CONTINUES as we CONTINUE TO:)

Scene 2

New Rochelle High School

FRANK JUNIOR

Everybody loved my dad. Jack Barnes, the head of the Chamber of Commerce, called him—

FRANK JUNIOR and JACK BARNES

—the most popular businessman in New Rochelle!

PAULA

Frankie, why are you wearing your old school blazer? You're going to public school now.

FRANK JUNIOR

It's only temporary. Dad'll get back on his feet and I'll be back at St. Francis before you know it. The Flash isn't the Flash without his uniform.

PAULA

My brave little soldier. You aren't afraid of anything.

FRANK JUNIOR

You do what you have to do.

PAULA

Well, you do look handsome. *Comme tu es beau!*

(She sighs, kisses him on the cheek, and goes.

Frank Junior heads to school.

He is met by a JOCK and a NERD)

FRANK JUNIOR

'Scuse me, is this room 17 French?

NERD

(checking his outfit)

Who wants to know? The F.B.I.?

(The two students LAUGH and move past him, the Jock accidentally-on-purpose bumping Frank Junior and sending him stumbling.)

JOCK

Yeah. He looks like a...like a substitute teacher or somethin'.

(STINGER.

Frank Junior looks at us and smiles.)

Should

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FRANK JUNIOR

Shouldn't you boys be in class? *Depechez-vous. Vite. Vite. Vite.*

(Lights change. Frank Senior and Paula are with a dour female PRINCIPAL.)

PRINCIPAL

Mr. and Mrs. Abagnale, I regret to inform you that for the past week, Frank has been teaching Mrs. Glaser's French class.

PAULA

He what?

PRINCIPAL

Your son has been pretending to be a substitute teacher. Lecturing the students, giving out homework. Your son held three teacher-parent conferences yesterday, and was planning a class field trip to a French Fry Factory in Trenton.

(Frank Junior waits, nervously, outside the Principal's office.)

PAULA

You have to forgive him. There's been so much change. We lost the house—

FRANK SENIOR

(smoothly cuts her off)

Principal Owings, on my way in from the outer office, I found this necklace on the floor. Is it yours?

(He pulls a locket necklace from his pocket.)

PAULA

Frank, please.

FRANK SENIOR

You must have dropped it. Looks like it was made for you.

PRINCIPAL

Well. Mister Abagnale.

(But she takes it. As Frank Senior shakes hands with the Principal, who exits opposite, Paula goes to Frank Junior.)

PAULA

FRANKIE.

(She shakes her head again and goes. Frank Senior takes her place, putting on his hat. Looks at his son, who slowly meets his gaze.)

FRANK SENIOR

French fry factory?!

(Finally, Frank Senior LAUGHS. And Frank Junior LAUGHS.)

FRANK SENIOR & FRANK JUNIOR

YEAH, WE'RE GONNA HIT THE HIGH-LIFE
WE'VE ONLY JUST BEGUN
WE'RE GONNA BE TOGETHER
FRANK SENIOR AND SON

DINE AT "THE LATIN QUARTER"
A NIGHTCAP AT "TOOTS SHOR"
WE'RE GONNA BE AT RINGSIDE
AND LIFE WILL BE BETTER THAN BEFORE
FOR TWO KIDS IN A MAN'S CANDY STORE

#2a - Pinstripes Tag

(Frank Senior claps his son on the shoulder and goes. Frank Junior moves to follow, but sees BETTY.)

FRANK JUNIOR

Hi.

BETTY

Hi. Is the Principal in her office? I need to give her this note from my mother, excusing me from sixth period.

FRANK JUNIOR

You should fold it. It's more believable that way.

BETTY

No, this really is a note from my mother.

FRANK JUNIOR

What's the first thing you do when your mother hands you a note? You fold it up and put it in your pocket.

(A half-beat, and Betty folds the note.)

BETTY

Thanks. I'm Betty.

FRANK JUNIOR

Frank.

Nice]

(Sf

(F

BETTY

Nice jacket.

(She plants an impulsive kiss on his cheek, and goes. He swoons and sings.)

FRANK JUNIOR

WHAT THEY SEE IS THE UNIFORM

JUST ASK ONE MAITRE D'

OR A TAILOR IN PARIS

GO ASK ROGER MARIS!

THE PINSTripES ARE ALL THAT THEY SEE

(Frank Junior dances his way home as we TRANSITION TO...)

Scene 3

The Abagnale Apartment, Downtown New Rochelle

FRANK JUNIOR

Mom, Dad I met this girl—

(...and as Frank Junior dances in the door, his mother and father dance on opposite. But with a turn, in an instant, we see that it's not his father. It's JACK BARNES. And Frank Junior sees this, and they see him.

MUSIC STOPS suddenly.)

PAULA

Frankie! You remember your father's friend, Jack Barnes?

JACK BARNES

Frank. Good to see you. Paula, take care.

(He grabs his hat and goes. Frank Junior is silent.)

PAULA

Are you hungry, Frankie? I'll make you a sandwich.

(Frank Junior doesn't move.)

Frankie?

(No answer.)

You're not going to tell him.

FRANK JUNIOR

No.

PAULA

That's right. There's nothing to tell. I'm going out for a few hours to visit some old friends from the tennis club, and when I get home, we'll all have dinner together, right?

(Frank Junior rubs his eyes. Paula gets her pocketbook.)

Do you need some money, Frankie? To buy some comic books? Here, take two dollars.

(She holds out the money to him, but he just looks at it. Then at her. MUSIC.)

FRANK JUNIOR

Two hundred soldiers in that tiny social hall, and you...you...

PAULA

I was sixteen years old when I met your father. I was your age. How could I know what I wanted? *Dites donc?*

FRANK JUNIOR

You wanted him.

PAULA

And I wanted to get out of France. And I wanted to have a child.

(She reaches for him, but he pulls away.)

(considers him, then)

It was a long time ago, Frankie. Believe me, one day you'll look at yourself, and you won't be who you were.

(He turns away from her and walks into his bedroom: piles of comic books, superhero posters, a "Flash" bedspread. He takes his jacket off and tosses it.)

FRANK JUNIOR

THERE'S NO PHONE BOOTH
THERE'S NO CAPE
THERE'S NO STEVE MCQUEEN
TO HELP ME MAKE MY GREAT ESCAPE

HOW CAN I FLY
LIKE A HERO IN THE SKY
BE A SHOOTING STAR OUT IN THE STRATOSPHERE

WHERE'S "THE SHADOW"?
HE MIGHT KNOW
WHERE'S THAT SEARCHLIGHT IN THE SKY
TO POINT THE WAY TO GO?

THROUGH SOME NEW CLOUD
TO DISAPPEAR INTO THE CROWD
THOUGH THE FUTURE'S DARK
THERE'S ONE THING CRYSTAL CLEAR.
THAT THERE'S NO HOME HERE...

(MUSIC CONTINUES as we TRANSITION TO:)

Scene 4

Family Court and Train Station, New Rochelle

(The Family Court Judge enters with Frank Senior and Paula...)

JUDGE

Son, listen to me. We just need a name. Your mother or your father.

(...and as the bedroom goes away, Frank Junior comes downstage for that "break-in-a-ballad" confessional moment.)

FRANK JUNIOR

(to us)

One day the principal pulls me out of class and drives me to the Courthouse. Doesn't tell me why. I walk in and see my parents up front, with their lawyers, and the judge.

JUDGE

It can get very expensive, people fighting over their children.

PAULA

Nobody's fighting. Look at me, Frank. Nobody's fighting.

(The adults continue, overlapping, as Frank Junior sings to us.)

FRANK JUNIOR

SO MANY VOICES TELLING ME TO CHOOSE

JUDGE

The court can decide these things, but it's better if the family does.

FRANK JUNIOR

IT'S LIKE A GAME WHERE EITHER TEAM I LOSE

FRANK SENIOR

Frank, just give them a name, and this will all be over. It's going to be okay.

FRANK JUNIOR

THIS KINDA NOISE JUST MAKES ME WANNA SHOUT

PAULA

My brave little soldier. Do what you have to do.

FRANK JUNIOR

I'D LIKE TO BUY A ONE-WAY TICKET OUT

FRANK SENIOR

Frank, I'm sorry. I've got no room to move here.

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FRANK JUNIOR

RULES OF THE ROAD SAY DON'T LOOK BACK
EYES STRAIGHT AHEAD, DON'T JUMP THE TRACK
TRY A NEW GAME
AND PRAY THAT I CAN WIN

'CAUSE I JUST DON'T FEEL AT HOME IN MINE
SO I'LL SLIP NOW
INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN

(And as the music hits a driving groove, Frank Junior turns and runs.

The Family Court disappears. Frank is on the street, COMMUTERS hurrying to and fro.)

COMMUTERS

HOO-HOO, HOO HOO

FRANK JUNIOR

I SEE THE MAPS FROM EVERY BOOK I'VE READ
THE WORLD'S THAT I HAVE LIVED INSIDE MY HEAD
I THOUGHT A LOVE LIKE THEIRS COULD NEVER DIE
IF IT CAN FADE AWAY THEN SO CAN I

FRANK JUNIOR

YEAH FIRST YOU SEE ME,
BUT THEN YOU DON'T

DON'T LOOK FOR ME YOU
KNOW I WON'T
EVEN BE THERE
SO LET THE GAMES BEGIN
CAUSE I
JUST DON'T FEEL AT HOME IN MINE
SO I'LL SLIP NOW
INTO SOMEONE
ELSE'S SKIN

ENSEMBLE

OO-OO-OO

KNOW I WON'T

AH-AH-AH-AH

AH-AH-AH-AH

HOO-HOO,

HOO-HOO

(New Rochelle Train Station. A ticket agent appears. Frank Junior hands him a couple of crumpled bills.)

FRANK JUNIOR

One for Grand Central Station, please.

RAILROAD AGENT

Round trip is five dollars. One way is three. You have two.

(The Railroad Agent holds up the bills. MUSIC CHANGES.)

Lights change, isolating Frank Junior. He looks at us, and speaks rapidly, without pause, as the Railroad Agent continues as if Frank Junior is still in the scene with him.)

FRANK JUNIOR

Okay, so I didn't really know what I was doing, I just knew I had to get out, and my instincts took over. Maintain eye contact. Keep talking. And I take my money back from the ticket seller and make it disappear —

(He does, using a nifty bit of sleight-of-hand. MUSIC CHANGES.)

— and I spin some tale about meeting my grandmother in the city while I ask for my change, even though he doesn't owe me any change —

RAILROAD AGENT

Wait, what?

FRANK JUNIOR

— but I keep talking, and waiting for my change, and in his confusion he gives me two dollars back, so now I have four dollars which is enough for my one way ticket to Manhattan, because I don't plan on coming back— Thanks, Mr. Morton!

(The Railroad Agent takes the money from Frank Junior, who takes the ticket without missing a beat.)

He turns to go, but:)

RAILROAD AGENT

Hold it!

FRANK JUNIOR

What?

RAILROAD AGENT

Your ticket.

FRANK JUNIOR

Thank you.

(MUSIC BUILDS.)

They wanted me to choose...and I chose the New Haven line, Track Two, the ten-fifteen to New York City!

FRANK JUNIOR

I'M GONNA
RUN DOWN THE STREET
RUN OUT OF TOWN
I'M GONNA RUN FROM THE
HOME TEAM
AND NEVER TOUCH DOWN
RUN FROM THE BOOKS
'CAUSE IT'S ALL BEEN A FAKE
I'M GONNA RUN FROM THE
CHOICES
THAT I DON'T WANNA MAKE
SCHOOL'S NOT OUT BUT
I CAN'T WAIT
IT'S THE PERFECT TIME TO
GRADUATE
TODAY
I'VE GOT TO RUN AWAY NOW
I'VE GOTTA RUN AWAY

I KNOW THEY'LL SEE THE
TRUTH WHEN I MOVE ON
THEY'LL NEED EACH OTHER
MUCH MORE ONCE I'M GONE
AND WHEN I'M FLUSH
AND HE'S BACK ON HIS FEET
I'LL PICK HIM UP AND
RIDE DOWN EASY STREET
NO TIME TO CRY
FOR ALL THE YEARS

A RUSTY GAS TANK
FULL OF TEARS
GETS YOU NOWHERE
NOT THE PLACES I WANT IN
AND I
JUST DON'T FEEL AT
HOME IN MINE
SO I'LL SLIP NOW
INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN

ENSEMBLE

RUN DOWN THE STREET
RUN OUT OF TOWN

RUN FROM THE BOOKS
'CAUSE IT'S ALL BEEN A FAKE

AHHH
AHHH
AHHH
AHHH
TODAY-AY-AY-AY
HOO-HOO
HOO-HOO

OO-OO-OO

FULL OF TEARS

AH-AH
AH-AH
AH-AH-AH-AH

(FRANK JUNIOR)

INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN

INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN

INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN

(ENSEMBLE)

INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN

INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN

INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN

INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN

INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN

INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN

INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S

INTO SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN

#3a

(MUSIC CONTINUES *as we* TRANSITION TO:)

Scene 5**Chase Bank, Manhattan**

(On applause from SOMEONE ELSE'S SKIN, Frank Junior comes downstage to speak to us.)

#3a - A Word From Our Sponsors**FRANK JUNIOR**

And now, ladies and gentlemen, a word from my sponsors!

(He gestures, and three ATTRACTIVE ASSISTANTS come dancing in.)

These great products can help you survive your first few weeks in New York with just fifty checks and a driver's license.

(Three ATTRACTIVE ASSISTANTS bring in the products as Frank describes them.)

Swiss Army Penknives can help you alter the age on your driver's license. Because a sixteen-year-old cashing a check or opening an account by himself—

ATTRACTIVE ASSISTANT #1

(with Swiss Army knife)

—gets a lot of questions!

FRANK JUNIOR

Higgins brand Genuine Original India Ink flows easy through your pen or brush—a few dabs on your license, you're ten years older.

ATTRACTIVE ASSISTANT #2

(with bottle of ink)

And no one can tell the difference!

FRANK JUNIOR

Elmer's Glue is perfect for the craftsperson of any age who needs to change their name. With a pair of scissors you can cut and paste names from other documents, and you're officially Frank Taylor Junior. And if Frank Taylor wears out his welcome—

ATTRACTIVE ASSISTANT #3

(with Elmer's Glue)

You can be Frank Williams!

ATTRACTIVE ASSISTANT #2

Or Frank Conners.

ATTRACTIVE ASSISTANT #1

Or William Taylor.

ASSISTANT #1

A SNIP,

ASSISTANT #2

A DAB,

ASSISTANT #3

A TOUCH OF GLUE

FOUR ASSISTANTS

AND YOU'LL BE GOOD TO GO

FRANK JUNIOR

BIG THANKS TO ALL OUR SPONSORS!

FOUR ASSISTANTS

NOW, RIGHT BACK TO THE SHOW!

(As the Attractive Assistants dance off)

#3b - Sponsors Tag

FRANK JUNIOR

In a few short months I soaked every branch of Chase Manhattan in the five boroughs and northern New Jersey and dropped rubber in just about every hotel, grocery store, and dry cleaners from here to Hoboken. I was the Johnny Appleseed of fraud.

BANK TELLER

I'm sorry, Mister Taylor. I can't cash this a check this large without my manager's approval. If you'd like to wait a moment I can go get...

FRANK JUNIOR

Say, Diane, I found this on the sidewalk out front, and I think it might be yours --

(He bends to his valise)

BANK TELLER

Well Mister Taylor ...

FRANK JUNIOR

It looks like it was made for you.

BANK TELLER

Well...Uh...perhaps I can make an exception for one of our most valued customers.

Thank

#3c - It

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FRANK JUNIOR

Thank you Diane.

#3c - Intro to F.B.I. Scene

Once my first fifty checks ran out, I bought a little printing press and made my own. I was producing more rubber than a tire factory. Mister Hanratty and his team were still trying to pick up my trail.

(Frank Junior sings as we TRANSITION:)

AND THOUGH I'M LIVE IN LIVING COLOR
AT THE FBI THE SHOW'S IN BLACK AND WHITE.

(A cluttered, down-on-its-heels FBI office with lots of filing cabinets, overflowing wastebaskets and too many pizza boxes. You wouldn't want to work there.)

Four men in suits and ties are present. They are BILL COD, TOD BRANTON, JOHNNY DOLLAR, a rookie, and CARL HANRATTY, whom we've already met and the only one who seems to be actually working at his desk. The others have their feet up on their desks and are doing what they generally do best: belly-aching.

The phone is ringing.)

BRANTON

So anyway, to make a long story short, we're having turkey for Christmas after all. "I was just trying to expand your taste buds," she tells me. "They don't need no expanding," I tell her. "Normal people don't eat goose."

(CARL HANRATTY answers the phone)

HANRATTY

FBI...

BRANTON

The lower depths.

HANRATTY

This is special agent Carl Hanratty. Merry Christmas.

COD

It's all that Julia Childs' fault. She puts 'em up to it. What was wrong with American food? Nothing, till she came along. You'd open a can of tuna, chop some onions and celery, add mayo, mix 'em all together and *voila!* Haute cuisine. I hate Public Television.

DOLLAR

Me, too. All they do is talk.

COD

Who asked you, Agent Dollar? Did I ask you? Did Agent Branton ask you? Did anyone in this building ask you?

DOLLAR

No, sir.

(HANRATTY has hung up the phone)

HANRATTY

Leave the kid alone.

BRANTON

We're only having some fun with him, Carl. We always give the rookies a hard time. Don't you remember how they razzed you?

HANRATTY

Yes, and it's an experience I see no reason to repeat. Now we've got at least three or four major-league paperhangers working the region, and we are going to sort this all out, even if it means we drop dead at our desks and our fossilized bones are discovered under some archeological dig in the twenty-first century.

COD

C'mon Hanratty it's 4:45. It's Christmas eve.

HANRATTY

Look—We do the job because it's the job and as long as I'm Interim Second Assistant Special Agent in Charge of the Bank Fraud and Forgery Subdivision—thank you very much—we damn well do the job until it's done. Christmas or no Christmas.

BRANTON

Easy for you to say, Hanratty. Some of us still have wives.

HANRATTY

Low blow, Agent Branton. And by the way, go home for lunch one of these days, unannounced, and see how that works out for you.

(The men laugh.)

Look, I know there are days this job lacks a certain excitement quotient.

COD

He means every day, kid.

HANRATTY

Days you can't get out from behind your desk, there's so much paper work. Weeks without a lead in a case. Months of dead ends. Years of coming up empty-handed. Time will seem to stop. Nobody knows you're down here. Except him, the one you're after. He knows. He's why you plod on. The day you catch him, and you will, the day you slap those cuffs on him —

#3d - F.B.I. Scene

(HANRATTY)

(he compares 2 checks)

—oh, now this is interesting. This is very, very interesting.

BRANTON

I know you think so, and that's the sad thing.

HANRATTY

Wait a minute! Look at these two. He's changing the MICR numbers on the checks.

DOLLAR

The what?

HANRATTY

M-I-C-R. Magnetic Ink Character Recognition. Jiminy Christmas, Frank Taylor must've got his hands on a MICR encoder.

(looks at the other check)

And so did William Franklin. Look here. If you change a zero-two to a one-two, a check that was cashed in New York gets rerouted all the way to San Francisco and it's weeks before the banks that cashed it knows it's bad.

DOLLAR

You mean those numbers at the bottom the check actually mean something?

HANRATTY

They mean Frank Taylor and Frank Williams and William Franklin are all the same person. Which means he can stay in one place and pass bad checks for weeks and weeks. Which means there must be thousands more of these out there— More bum checks than a Prague prison. Branton, send a field bulletin to the tri-state area. And you, mister whatever your name is, I'm on you like a hobo on a ham sandwich.

(Transition to...)

Scene 6

Outside the Tudor Hotel, Manhattan, and in the Skies

#4 - Jet Set

FRANK JUNIOR

I'd always wanted to be good at something. Now I was really good...at passing bad checks. I was a crook, nothing more. But then one day, as I went walking past the Tudor Hotel on 42nd Street, destiny came walking out those revolving doors.

(He almost collides with a beautiful young Pan Am STEWARDESS emerging, travel bag in hand.)

Gosh, I'm so—

(He takes her measure.)

—sorry.

STEWARDESS #1 (CINDY)

It's quite all right.

(She continues past him, as Frank watches, agape. A SECOND STEWARDESS comes through the door.)

STEWARDESS #2 (MINDY)

Excuse me.

FRANK JUNIOR

Uhh—no, excuse me—kinda late to be checking out, isn't it?

STEWARDESS #2 (MINDY)

We all have evening flights.

FRANK JUNIOR

"We all...?"

(A parade of STEWARDESSES, all in the same Pan Am outfit, march in through the door, satchels in hand. He bobs and weaves as they move through.)

FRANK JUNIOR

Oh, I—excuse me—whoops!—hello, there...

(STEWARDESS #3 bumps him on her way by...)

STEWARDESS #3 (LINDY)

Oh! Excuse me.

FRANK JUNIOR

No...excuse me. Um. Who are you all waiting for?

THE STEWARDESSES

The pilots.

(Frank Junior blinks.

STINGER.

He smiles at us, then at her.)

FRANK JUNIOR

Excuse me, miss...I've been training as a pilot. Is Pan Am hiring?

STEWARDESS #1 (CINDY)

Aren't you sweet. Here.

(She pulls a business card from her bust. It's the wrong one. She pulls another; then the third time's the charm.)

Here it is. Talk to Jerry Taylor, VP of personnel. Tell him Cindy sent you.

FRANK JUNIOR

Thank you, Miss Cindy. Tell me—is flying everything it's cracked up to be?

STEWARDESS #1 (CINDY)

The only thing better than flying—is a good long layover.

(Frank Junior steps downstage: to us, our host.)

FRANK JUNIOR

Cindy, Mindy, Lindy, Kellie, Shellie, Nellie, Sherrie, Terri, Karrie, and Jane. I like to call them "The Jet Set."

CINDY

WOKE UP IN BROOKLYN

WITH A FROWN UPON MY FACE

(One by one, the other Stewardesses join her, telling Frank Junior how it is.)

MINDY

JUST LEFT WISCONSIN

WHERE THERE'S CHEESE ENOUGH

TO START THIS RAT RACE

CINDY

BUT THANKS TO THE BROTHERS WRIGHT

CINDY + MINDY

WE DON'T KNOW WHERE WE'LL SLEEP TONIGHT

CINDY

YEAH, I'M A BIRD IN THE SKIES

MINDY

AND TOMORROW WHEN I RISE

LINDY

I'LL WAKE UP IN PARIS

WITH A NEW LOVE IN MY HEART

SHELLIE

OR MAYBE GERMANY

WITH THAT BRAND NEW PET

I MET IN STUTTGART

NELLIE

SKY'S THE LIMIT, IT'S TIME TO PLAY

I'LL PUT DOWN ROOTS SOME OTHER DAY

JANE

NO NEED TO BE A LONELY JOB

STEWARDESSES

THE JET-SET IS THE

JANE

ONLY WAY TO GO

(One Stewardess pulls a pair of horn-rimmed glasses from her satchel and puts them on Frank Junior. Another Stewardess opens her satchel, and he takes out a camera and a notebook. A PAN AM EXECUTIVE enters.)

PAN AM EXECUTIVE

So you're the kid writing the article for the school paper?

FRANK JUNIOR

(turns to him, now a high school kid)

Yes sir. Frank Black from Monroe High School. I want to know everything there is to know about being a Pan Am pilot. For instance, what does it mean when one pilot says to another pilot, "I've been on the same equipment all week, jumpin' puddles for the weak and weary?"

PAN AM EXECUTIVE

Means they've been flying the same plane, short flights, mostly commuters.

FRANK JUNIOR

And what about those I.D. badges that I've seen pilots wear?

PAN AM EXEC

Every pilot has to have it with him at all times. It's an airline personnel badge, like this one here from Pan Am.

FRANK JUNIOR

Thank you for your time, sir! Can I get a picture?

PAN AM EXEC

Oh, sure.

(Frank Junior points the camera right at his ID badge. FLASH.)

FRANK JUNIOR

Got it!

(The Executive goes and the Stewardesses are back.)

STEWARDESSES

WOULD'JA LIKE NEW MUSIC AND MYST'RY
EACH AND EVERYDAY
LOSE THE SAME OLD MUSIC AND HIST'RY
MAKE A NEW FRIEND THEN
FLY AWAY

(One Stewardess brings Frank Junior an in-flight cart with familiar sponsor products: Penknife, scissors, glue, India ink. Frank holds up a blank piece of paper, and goes to work making a Pan Am Badge.)

AND...WAKE UP IN TEXAS
WHERE THEY TREAT THEIR WOMEN RIGHT
AND THEN TRY HOLLYWOOD
WHERE THE STARS GET LIT
OUT IN BROAD DAYLIGHT

ANY CITY, NEAR OR FAR
FEELS TWICE AS GOOD AS WHERE YOU ARE
WHEN YOU'RE SICK OF THE STATUS QUO
THE JET-SET IS
THE ONLY WAY TO GO...

(Frank Junior holds up his completed badge.)

FRANK JUNIOR

My Pan Am pilot's badge! How cool is that?

(A Stewardess wheels the cart away.)

A TAILOR enters, uniform jacket in his hand, pants draped over his arm.)

TAILOR

Awfully young to be a pilot, aren't ya?

FRANK JUNIOR

I get that a lot. I'm just a co-pilot.

TAILOR

(putting the jacket on him)

Why so nervous?

FRANK JUNIOR

How would you feel if you lost your uniform your first week on the job?

TAILOR

Ah, I hear you. That'll be one forty-three ninety-seven.

FRANK JUNIOR

Can I write you a check?

TAILOR

No—no checks, no cash. Just need your employee number.

(He pulls out a form and begins to fill it out. Frank tries to read it upside down, to count spaces for numbers;)

FRANK JUNIOR

Of course. It's. Six. One. Four...zero. Three.(?) Five.(?) S—

(But before he gets the next number out, the Tailor nods, finished, and Frank Junior pulls it back.)

TAILOR

Great! I'll bill Pan Am, they'll take it out of your next paycheck.

FRANK JUNIOR

Even better.

(Frank Junior and the Tailor go off as the PILOTS enter with Stewardesses.)

ALL PILOTS

WOULD'JA LIKE A SLEIGH RIDE, A HAYRIDE?
THEN KIDDO, JUST STAY HOME
BUT, IF YOU WANT JET-SET THEN GET SET
TO LEAVE BEHIND KANSAS
THERE'S NO PLACE LIKE ROME

ALL STEWARDESSES

WAKE UP IN RIO
HAVE YOUR COFFEE IN BRAZIL

ALL PILOTS

WHEN REAL LIFE GETS YOU DOWN
TAKE A

PILOTS and STEWARDESSES

FAR-OUT, ONE-WAY
TRIP TO SPLITZVILLE

ALL PILOTS

SWEDISH, GREEK OR JAPANESE

ALL STEWARDESSES

A STEWARDESS IS TRAINED TO PLEASE

ALL

SO IF YOU'VE GOT WHAT IT TAKES BELOW
WELL THEN FLY THIS BIRD LIKE CUPID'S BOW
CAUSE THE JET SET'S JUST A HOLIDAY
YEAH THE JET SET GOES
UP, UP AND AWAY...SO FLY!

(Frank Junior joins them, his uniform at last perfect, cap and aviators on. A stunning sight.)

FRANK JUNIOR

RIGHT DOWN TO IT'LY FOR LA BELLA FEMINA
JUMP IN A FOUNTAIN

STEWARDESSES

WOO!

FRANK JUNIOR

FOR A

PILOTS and STEWARDESSES

BIG DOSE OF LA DOLCE VITA

FRANK JUNIOR

IF YOUR TASTES RUN MORE RISQUÉ

TWO STEWARDESSES

WELL THEN, WE KNOW A JOINT IN OLD BOMBAY

ALL

SO HANG ON TIGHT
LET'S LOOP DE LOOP
IT'S TIME TO FLY
THIS CHICKEN COOP

SO PACK UP YOUR SUITCASE
CHECK YOUR WORRIES AT THE GATE
COME OUT AND PLAY BOY
CRUISE THE WORLD TO FIND
YOUR PERFECT PLAYMATE

FRANK JUNIOR

THINGS LOOK BETTER FROM ABOVE
SO BUCKLE UP, NEXT STOP IS LOVE

ALL

FROM TIMBUKTU TO TOKYO
FROM MOZAMBIQUE TO MEXICO
YEAH THE JET SET IS THE
ONLY WAY TO GO

FRANK JUNIOR

BA DA BA BOP BA BA BA DA BA

ALL

OH-OH!

SONG ENDS.

#4a - Jet Set Playoff

(MUSIC begins again. As the others exit, one Stewardess retrieves Frank Junior...
until he sees CHERYL ANN coming the other way, and he turns and follows her as we
TRANSITION TO...)

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Scene 7**The Plaza Hotel, Manhattan**

(In the hotel corridor, Cheryl Ann senses Frank Junior and stops and turns.)

CHERYL ANN

Nice uniform.

FRANK JUNIOR

Um. Do I know you from somewhere?

CHERYL ANN

Maybe. I was on the cover of Seventeen...a few years ago.

FRANK JUNIOR

Oh, wow, yeah—you're that model! Cheryl Ann—something—in the Plaza. Gee, d'you think I could get an autograph?

CHERYL ANN

Do you have a pen...in your room?

FRANK JUNIOR

Um. I think I do.

CHERYL ANN

So. Captain.

FRANK JUNIOR

Oh—call me Frank.

CHERYL ANN

Frank. Are you going to make me an offer?

FRANK JUNIOR

I — I'm sorry — an offer for what?

CHERYL ANN

A man like you can buy anything he wants. What's a night worth? With me?

(She opens her fur coat to reveal to FRANK JR that she's naked underneath)

FRANK JUNIOR

I — gosh, I really don't know, Cheryl.— Um. Three hundred?

(She closes her coat)

Five hundred?

(She starts down the hallway.)

A thousand?

(She stops. Turns.)

CHERYL ANN

One thousand dollars.

FRANK JUNIOR

(he reaches in a pocket and grabs a wad of checks)

I have to cash a check.

CHERYL ANN

You think this hotel is going to cash a thousand dollar check at three a.m.?

FRANK JUNIOR

(rifling through the checks and pulling one out)

They've done it for me before. It's a cashier's check.

CHERYL ANN

(she takes it and inspects it)

Endorse it over to me.

FRANK JUNIOR

It's for fourteen hundred.

CHERYL ANN

You give me the check...

(pulling cash from her bust)

...and I'll give you four hundred dollars.

(She hands him the check and the cash and turns to go)

FRANK JUNIOR

Even better.

(MUSIC. He follows her off.)

#4b - Transition to Firing Range

Scene 8**A Firing Range, FBI Training Ground, Quantico, VA**

(As Frank Junior leaves with Cheryl Ann, Hanratty and the men enter, guns a blazing. Hanratty takes aim and fires off a round.)

BRANTON

(as he reloads)

So, Hanratty, why the hell did you drag us out to Quantico? This guy's a pen and ink man. A paperhanger. He probably doesn't even carry a gun.

HANRATTY

We're getting closer to this guy. You need to get back some of the skills you've lost, sitting around, sneaking peppermint schnapps from your coffee cup.

BRANTON

But we can't fix a location. One day he's in Dallas. The next he's in Stuttgart. Rome. Barcelona.

COD

He's gone global. The last bad checks came in from Liechtenstein. Where the hell is Liechtenstein?

HANRATTY

The principality of Liechtenstein is a landlocked alpine country in Western Europe bordered by Switzerland to the west and south and Austria to the east.

BRANTON

He's just a forger, Hanratty. There's no way the Bureau's gonna give us travel money to Lichten-what.

COD

Lichtenstein.

BRANTON

Yeah.

HANRATTY

This guy's just a forger like Mickey Mantle is just a hitter. He's got my dander up and my interest piqued. (That's "piqued" with a "Q"). It hasn't peaked in a long time. (That's "peaked" with a "K")! He's not just playing the game, boys. He's making the rules. He's a true talent.

COD

Jesus, Hanratty. You want to arrest him or hire him?

HANRATTY

I see this guy in my sleep. Sixtyish, salt-and-pepper, tall. He's Old School, a virtuoso. He's been honing his craft for years. But, they always make a mistake.

(HANRATTY)

It's the overconfidence. Or the wine. Or the women.

(Bullets WHIZ and DING and they duck for cover.)

BRANTON

What the hell!

DOLLAR

(entering)

You know, if shooting people is anything like target practice, it's very disappointing. I didn't feel a thing.

HANRATTY

Doggone it, this job is not about shooting at people. And it's not about punching the clock, waiting for retirement, or enjoying a quickie with the secretary on 3. It's about just one guy - this Frank Taylor a.k.a. Frank Williams a.k.a. William Franklin. He's out there, toying with me. Taunting me.

COD

C'mon, Hanratty. He doesn't even know you exist.

HANRATTY

He will. Believe it. He will.

BRANTON

Okay, okay. Stay cool.

HANRATTY

I will not stay cool. I have never been cool and I don't intend to start now.

BRANTON

Hanratty, were you always like this?

HANRATTY

Long as I can remember.

(MUSIC.)

#5 - Don't Break The Rules

I think I was born this way. Other kids wanted to play cops and robbers. I only wanted to play cops.

IT STARTS VERY EARLY
ONCE THE BABY TOYS ARE GONE
A KID ON THE PLAYGROUND
HAS TO CHOOSE WHAT SIDE HE'S ON

(HANRATTY)

IT'S THE BULLIES OR THE GOOD GUYS
BOY, THERE IS NO MIDDLE GROUND
THOUGH HOODLUMS TRY TO BLUR THE LINE
AND TWIST THE TRUTH AROUND

THEN THEY CALL THEMSELVES A WINNER
BUT THEY'RE SELF-DECEIVING FOOLS
'CAUSE THE GAME AIN'T WORTH WINNING
IF YOU'RE BREAKING ALL THE RULES

THE LAW IS LAYED UPON US
WHEN AS KIDS WE FIRST ASK "WHY?"
OUR PARENTS SET THE RULES
WHEN "'CAUSE I SAID SO," THEY REPLY

AND THOUGH I THOUGHT I HATED THEM
AND SCREAMED WITH ALL MY MIGHT
THE NEXT TIME THAT I HAD A CHOICE
GEE WHIZ! I DID WHAT'S RIGHT

NO, I NEVER SNUCK A DRINK
I NEVER STOLE A PACK OF "KOOLS"
'CAUSE THE GAME AIN'T WORTH WINNING
IF YOU'RE BREAKING ALL THE RULES

HANRATTY

OR ELSE WE'RE LIVING
IN THE WILD WILD WEST

GOD'S KEEPING SCORE
YOU DON'T WANNA
RAIL THAT TEST

YOU THUMB YOUR NOSE
RIGHT AT THE LIFE
FOR WHICH I STRIVE
BUT THOSE RULES,
THOSE LAWS
KEEP US ALIVE.

AGENTS & TARGETS

DON'T BREAK THE RULES

DON'T BREAK THE RULES

DON'T BREAK THE RULES

BUT THOSE RULES
THOSE LAWS
KEEP US ALIVE.

(HANRATTY)

IT STARTED BACK WITH MOSES
WHEN HE LED AROUND THE JEWS

AND CLIMBED WAY
UP THAT MOUNTAIN
TO PICK UP GOD'S DAILY
NEWS

HE SCHLEPPED UP OLD MT. SINAI
CRIED AND BEGGED
ON THEIR BEHALF

HE ALMOST DROPPED
THOSE TABLETS
WHEN HE SAW THAT
GOLDEN CALF

NOW WE WE TEACH THE
TEN COMMANDMENTS
EVERY SUNDAY
IN OUR SCHOOLS
'CAUSE THE GAME
AIN'T WORTH WINNING
IF YOU'RE BREAKING
ALL THE RULES

I GUESS
THE CONSTITUTION, BOYS,
TO SOME IS TOO COMPLEX

THEY THINK
OUR FOUNDING FATHERS FOUGHT
SO THEY COULD FORGE
SOME CHECKS

THEY SEE THEMSELVES
AS ROBIN HOOD
STEALING FROM THE RICH

(AGENTS & TARGETS)

THE JEWS

TELL ME THE NEWS

OH LORD

WHAT?

EVERY SUNDAY
IN OUR SCHOOLS

AND BABY
I GUESS

WE'RE THINKING
THEY THINK

AND NOW IT'S LOOKIN'
THEY SEE THEMSELVES

BUT DON'T YA KNOW THEY'RE

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T

(HANRATTY)

NOT PAYING BACK
THE THINGS THEY TAKE
WELL PAYBACK IS A BITCH
'CAUSE THE WORLD AIN'T
SHERWOOD FOREST
YOU CAN'T GIVE AWAY
THOSE JEWELS
'CAUSE THE GAME
AIN'T WORTH WINNING
IF YOU'RE BREAKING
ALL THE RULES

OR ELSE WE'RE LIVING
IN THE WILD WILD WEST

GOD'S KEEPING SCORE
YOU DON'T WANNA
FAIL THAT TEST

YOU THUMB YOUR NOSE
RIGHT AT THE LIFE
FOR WHICH I STRIVE
BUT THOSE RULES,
THOSE LAWS
KEEP US ALIVE.

WHEN THEY STEAL
SOMEBODY'S MONEY
SCREW HIS DAUGHTER
OR HIS WIFE

YOU DON'T THINK
OF REPERCUSSIONS
AS YOU TAP DANCE
THROUGH YOUR LIFE

(AGENTS & TARGETS)

NOT PAYING BACK

POW

YOU CAN'T GIVE AWAY
THOSE JEWELS

DON'T BREAK THE RULES

DON'T BREAK THE RULES

DON'T BREAK THE RULES

BUT THOSE RULES
THOSE LAWS
KEEP US ALIVE.
US ALIVE
OO-OO ...

BOP
OO-OO ...

BOP
OO-OO ...

(HANRATTY)

THOUGH YOU SMILE
LIKE YOU'RE A HERO
YOU'RE AN OUTLAW
THROUGH AND THROUGH
BUT THE ODDS ARE
IN MY FAVOR, MAN
AND ONE DAY
I'LL CATCH YOU
SO, GO SNEAK INTO A MOVIE
RUN A RED LIGHT,
SELL SOME POT

IT'S ALL THE SAME TO ME
YOU'RE EITHER GUILTY
OR YOU'RE NOT

IF WE ALL DID
WHAT WE WANTED
EVERY TIME WE FELT THE URGE
THE WORLD WOULD BE
IN TOTAL CHAOS
IT'S ALREADY ON THE VERGE

YES, ITS LAWS THAT
KEEP US HUMAN
'CAUSE WITHOUT THEM
WE'RE JUST MULES
AND
THE GAME AIN'T WORTH WINNING
YES
THE GAME AIN'T WORTH WINNING
NO
THE GAME AIN'T WORTH WINNING
IF YOU'RE BREAKING
ALL THE RULES

OR ELSE WE'RE LIVING
IN THE WILD WILD WEST

(AGENTS & TARGETS)

YOU'RE AN OUTLAW
THROUGH AND THROUGH

AND ONE DAY
I'LL CATCH YOU
SO GO SNEAK

DOO WOP DOO WOP

DOO WOP DOO WOP
WOW

THE WORLD WOULD BE
IN TOTAL CHAOS

BOP

CAUSE WITHOUT THEM
WE'RE JUST MULES

THE GAME AIN'T WORTH WINNING

THE GAME AIN'T WORTH WINNING

THE GAME AIN'T WORTH WINNING

DON'T BREAK THE RULES

GOD'S
YOU I
FAIL T

YOU I
RIGHT
FOR V

WHA!

SING

KEEP

All:

#5a-

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Goc

Yes,
and

Fire

The

(HANRATTY)

GOD'S KEEPING SCORE
YOU DON'T WANNA
FAIL THAT TEST

YOU THUMB YOUR NOSE
RIGHT AT THE LIFE
FOR WHICH I STRIVE

WHATTCHA SAY?

SING IT BOYS

KEEP US ALIVE

(AGENTS & TARGETS)

DON'T BREAK THE RULES

DON'T BREAK THE RULES

BUT THOSE RULES
THOSE LAWS

THOSE RULES
THOSE LAWS

THOSE RULES
THOSE LAWS
KEEP US ALIVE
BOP

HANRATTY

All right, back to work. Crime doesn't take a holiday. I can't believe I just said that!

#5a - Don't Break Playoff

(The FBI Agents scatter.)

SPLIT STAGE. Frank Junior enters with his suitcase. A lovely STEWARDESS enters opposite, with a clipboard.)

STEWARDESS

Good morning, First Officer. Are you my deadhead today?

FRANK JUNIOR

Yes, ma'am. Been on the same equipment all week, jumpin' puddles for the weak and weary.

STEWARDESS

First class is full, but I've got the jump seat open. Come on aboard.

FRANK JUNIOR

Thanks!

STEWARDESS

Be sure to watch out for that Skywayman.

FRANK JUNIOR

Skywayman?

(The Stewardess hands him a newspaper, opened and folded to an article. Frank Jr. scans it.)

BRANTON

You're dangerous, kid. Who the hell taught you to shoot?

DOLLAR

My Daddy taught me to turn a mister to a misses from 100 yards.

(Cod enters, with a flyer in hand.)

COD

Hanratty. I'm gonna regret this, but look at this field bulletin.

(Hanratty grabs and scans it.)

HANRATTY + FRANK JUNIOR

(overlapping; not in unison)

The Skywayman. All the airlines are after him...posing as an airline pilot...flying all over the world...

STEWARDESS

They don't know how he does it.

FRANK JUNIOR

The Skywayman. Like a superhero. Crazy world we live in. I'll have to look out for him.

STEWARDESS

Would you like something to drink before we take off?

FRANK JUNIOR

Um, milk?

(Frank Junior gives the paper back to the Stewardess and exits. She follows.)

HANRATTY

All right, boys. We're checking every airport hotel, motel, cafe, and commissary on the Atlantic seaboard. We just became front page news.

(MUSIC. Hanratty and the boys exit and we go right to the Latin Quarter.)

#6 -

#6 -

Scene 9

The Latin Quarter, New York City

#6 - Latin Quarter Pinstripes

(A floor show is just finishing, with the girls dressed in pinstripes.)

SHOWGIRLS

UNDERNEATH IS MY UNIFORM
ALL IN SILK, FROM PAREE
A MAN CAN MAKE PASSES
OR USE X-RAY GLASSES
BUT! PINSTripES ARE ALL THAT HE'LL SEE!

(FRANK JR and FRANK SR are seated at a table at the elegant and legendary New York restaurant)

#6a - Swank Restaurant Source

FRANK SENIOR

This place...something else. They have a guy to give towels to the guy who gives you towels.

FRANK JUNIOR

I heard about it in Paris, I thought it might be just the place to take you when I got back to the States.

FRANK SENIOR

My son the birdman. Where're you flying that plane tonight?

FRANK JUNIOR

Well, I don't—I don't really fly. I'm sort of just a co-pilot.

FRANK SENIOR

Where?

FRANK JUNIOR

Los Angeles.

FRANK SENIOR

Hollywood.

FRANK JUNIOR

Yeah.

FRANK SENIOR

Look at us, Frankie. On top of the world.

FRANK JUNIOR

Dad. I went by the store today.

FRANK SENIOR

I had to close the store for a while. It's all about timing, Frank. The goddamn government knows that, they hit you when you're down. I wasn't going to let them take it from me. So I just shut the doors myself. Called their bluff. Sooner or later, they'll forget about me.

(Frank Junior slides a thick envelope across the table.)

What's this?

FRANK JUNIOR

Let's open the store up, Dad. Pay off the Feds. Get things back the way they were. I can help out now.

FRANK SENIOR

Keep it. You got your own worries.

FRANK JUNIOR

I'm fine. There's plenty more where this came from, believe me.

FRANK SENIOR

That's fine, Frankie. Take good care of yourself.

FRANK JUNIOR

But maybe if Mom sees—

FRANK SENIOR

Do I look like I need your help?

(A moment.

Frank Sr. to bartender.)

Double Bourbon.

(Back to Frank Junior.)

Don't worry about your mom and me. Frankie. She's stubborn, always has been. She's a formidable woman. But I won't let her go without a fight.

FRANK JUNIOR

If she saw you had the store back—

FRANK SENIOR

Two hundred GI's in that tiny social hall, watching her dance. I didn't speak a word of French. And six weeks later, she was my wife.

FRANK JUNIOR

She could be again.

FRANK SENIOR

I don't know, Frankie.

FRANK JUNIOR

Listen, Dad, everything's different now. I got this great job. I make lots of money.
I can have breakfast in Rome, lunch in Miami, and dinner in San Francisco.

(MUSIC)

#7 - Butter Outta Cream

FRANK SENIOR

And here I thought you were just a copilot. I'm proud of you, son.

FRANK JUNIOR

REMEMBER THAT STORY I LEARNED AT YOUR FEET
WELL NOW IT'S MY TURN, TAKE A SEAT

TWO LITTLE MICE OF GREAT RENOWN
FELL IN SOME MILK AND ONE PROCEEDED TO DROWN
THE OTHER ONE'S STILL THE TOAST OF THE TOWN
CAUSE HE MADE BUTTER OUTTA CREAM

HE LOOKED AROUND, DEDUCED HIS PLIGHT
SAID "THIS IS NO WAY TO SPEND A SATURDAY NIGHT!"
BUT HE HAD THE STYLE TO MAKE THINGS RIGHT
SO HE MADE BUTTER OUTTA CREAM

HE KICKED HIS LEGS UP
HE TOSSED AND TURNED
SO NOT TO END UP A GHOST
HE DID THE HOKEY-POKEY
TILL THE CREAM WAS CHURNED
THEN BABY, HE WALKED RIGHT OUT
AND BUTTERED HIS TOAST

NOW HE'S ON TOP FOR GOODNESS SAKES
YEAH, HE'S THE BIG CHEESE UP AT "LAND O' LAKES"
HE'S LIVING PROOF THAT POP ALL IT TAKES
IS A SCHEME

(FRANK JUNIOR)

SO IF YOU LAND IN THE GUTTER
JUST MAKE BUTTER OUT OF CREAM

FRANK JUNIOR

Your turn, Dad.

FRANK SENIOR

Nah—you're doing great.

FRANK JUNIOR

Come on—we're a duo. Frank and Dean. I can't do this act solo.

FRANK SENIOR

Well, you know...there is one you haven't heard.

FRANK JUNIOR

Really?

FRANK SENIOR

THERE WAS A COCKROACH IN BRAZIL
GOT DRUNK AT THE LOCAL COFFEE MILL
HIS TIME WAS ALMOST UP UNTIL
HE MADE COFFEE OUTTA BEANS

WHEN HE CAME TO HE HEARD SUCH A SOUND
THEN MUCH TO HIS SHOCK WHEN HE LOOKED AROUND
HE HAD BEEN SCOOPED AND WAS ABOUT TO BE GROUND
SO, HE MADE COFFEE OUT OF BEANS

HE MARCHED TO THE SOUTH
AND HE STOMPED TO THE NORTH
HE HAD TO RACE AGAINST FATE
HE DID THE CUCARACHA 'TIL THE TEARS POURED FORTH
THEN SEÑOR, THINGS BEGAN TO PERCOLATE

HE HELD HIS BREATH AND SWAM TO THE TOP
BORROWED SOME BEANS FROM HIS MOM AND POP
THEN HE OPENED UP HIS OWN COFFEE SHOP
OUT IN QUEENS!
WHEN HIS LIGHTS WERE ALMOST OFF
HE JUST MADE COFFEE OUTTA BEANS

FRANK JUNIOR

Let's bring it home!

Al

Yo

Lil

#7a-

Alright!

FRANK SENIOR

BOTH

SO THINK OF THOSE TWO WHEN LIFE'S THE PITS

FRANK SENIOR

"THE BUG"

FRANK JUNIOR

AND "THE MOUSE"

BOTH

AT THE END OF THEIR WITS
THEY KNEW THE KEY TO LIFE
IS THAT ITS WHA' CHA DREAM
SO IF LEMONS CLOG YOUR SINK UP
DON'T JUST STAND AROUND AND SCREAM
SPIKE SOME LEMONADE AND DRINK UP
AND MAKE BUTTER OUT OF CREAM

FRANK SENIOR

JUST MAKE BUTTER OUT OF CREAM

FRANK JUNIOR

MAKE SOME BUTTER OUT OF CREAM

FRANK SENIOR

I HEAR WHAT YOU'RE SAYIN' SON,
I'LL MAKE BUTTER OUT OF CREAM!

FRANK JUNIOR

SHA-DOO-BAH DWEE-LEBYAH DO-BAH
DWEE-LE-YAH DOO-BOP!

FRANK SENIOR

You always gotta get the last word in!

FRANK JUNIOR

Like Father like Son! Come on!

Scene 10

Idlewild Airport Motel, Room 135

(Hanratty, Cod, and Dollar inspect a much-used motel room: comic books, junk-food containers, crumpled papers. Branton appears at the door.)

BRANTON

Hanratty! The manager says he just checked out three hours ago. Was here for almost a week. No forwarding.

COD

Looks like he left in a hurry.

HANRATTY

All right, gentlemen. Impress me. A man's secrets are in his trash.

(They begin to pore over the room, opening drawers, lifting cushions, inspecting furniture.)

Mister Taylor, real name unknown, left us a goldmine.

DOLLAR

(holds up a comic book)

The Flash. He likes comic books.

COD

(holds up a pizza box and a jar of peanut butter)

He lives on junk food.

BRANTON

(holds up a Playboy)

He has a breast fetish.

COD

Oh my god! It's Hanratty!

HANRATTY

Very funny. I'll make a note to laugh later.

(sighs and picks up the wastebasket)

Branton, Cod, go canvas the other guests. Dollar, get license plate numbers on every car in the lot. I'll process the room.

COD

(as the men leave)

Right.

Some

#8 - Th

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(E

All r

(The other agents go. MUSIC.)

HANRATTY

Something doesn't jive here.

#8 - The Man Inside The Clues

The Flash? Peanut butter? Maybe he's got a kid?

(Hanratty goes to work, picking through the garbage.)

All right, Mister Taylor. I know you're in here somewhere.

SOME COMIC BOOKS

A MISS JULY

A MATCHBOOK FROM "THE FLAME"

SOME CHEWING GUM

A MISMATCHED PAIR OF SHOES

A LETTER HOME

THAT WASN'T MAILED

A CHECK WITHOUT A NAME

YEAH, THEY'LL BE MY GUIDE

TO THE MAN INSIDE THE CLUES

A BOBBY PIN

TWO BASEBALL CARDS

SOME DAY-OLD CHINESE FOOD

SOME TICKET STUBS

THE RED SOX ALWAYS LOSE

A VALENTINE

THAT WASN'T SENT

A SCENT TO SET THE MOOD

WHEN I TAKE A RIDE

WITH THE MAN INSIDE THE CLUES

BRANTON

Anything?

HANRATTY

(hands him a crumpled sheet of paper)

Pan Am stationery.

(HANRATTY)

(reads)

"As a Pan Am pilot, my family flies for free. The two of you should come out to Los Angeles with me. Maybe then -"

(looks up)

Unfinished.

BRANTON

The two of who?

HANRATTY

Who knows? But we know he's going to Los Angeles. And so are we.

DOLLAR

Fantastic.

COD

(as he and Branton turn to go)

Now that's the best idea he's had yet.

BRANTON

He could use the sun. If he were any more pale, he'd be transparent.

(The men exit. Hanratty moves to follow, but stops, and returns to the room.)

HANRATTY

I'VE LOOKED INTO SO MANY LIVES
BUT NEVER AT MY OWN
THE TRAIL I'VE LEFT IS SUCH A DAMN CLICHÉ

THE LONELY WIFE, THE HOUSE FOR SALE
A MILLION NIGHTS ALONE
TO WISH YOU HAD THE THINGS YOU THREW AWAY...

LIKE A FRONT DOOR KEY
A HOME COOKED MEAL
THE HAPPY BRIDE AND GROOM
THEN LIFE KICKS IN AND MAKES YOU PAY YOUR DUES

AND THEN YOU FIND
YOU'RE BY YOURSELF
IN A SINGLE HOTEL ROOM
THAT'S BEEN OCCUPIED...

(Tra

(HANRATTY)

BY THE MAN INSIDE
THE CLUES
THE CLUES.

(Transition to...)

Scene 11

A Motel (Patio and Room) in Los Angeles

(Hanratty and men enter with the MOTEL MANAGER.)

MOTEL MANAGER

He wrote three checks. They all cleared. I was gonna deposit this one today. I don't want any trouble.

HANRATTY

There won't be any trouble. I'll just take this check and be on my way.

MOTEL MANAGER

Good. I don't want my customers harassed.

HANRATTY

You mean he's still here?

MOTEL MANAGER

(hesitates)

Two-oh-one.

HANRATTY

I take the lead. You guys watch the front, Dollar takes the other exit.

(Hanratty draws his gun. Dollar eagerly follows suit.)

Put it away.

(Dollar complies, glumly.)

If you're good little boys, I'll buy you all a Good Humor bar.

MOTEL MANAGER

You said there wouldn't be any trouble.

HANRATTY

Relax, mister, you'll get one, too.

(Hanratty proceeds, cautiously, gun drawn, to room 201. The rest exit, in other directions.)

Hanratty bursts in through the door...

F.B.I.

(...but the room is empty. Hanratty slowly moves in, looking over a bureau and table filled with the implements of forgery.)

From the bathroom, a FLUSH. Hanratty points his gun.)

(HANRATTY)

F.B.I! Come out with your hands on your head.

(Frank Junior calmly emerges from the bathroom. Nods at Hanratty. He's in a different, black suit.)

FRANK JUNIOR

Guy's got a MICR encoder, can you believe that?

HANRATTY

Don't move. Put your hands on your head or I'll shoot.

(Frank Junior ignores the gun pointed at him and walks to the desk.)

FRANK JUNIOR

He's got about two hundred checks here—a gallon of India ink, drafting glue—he even makes little payroll envelopes addressed to himself from Pan Am.

HANRATTY

Keep your hands where I can see them.

FRANK JUNIOR

Relax, buddy, you're late. The name's Allen, Barry Allen, United States Secret Service. Your man just tried to climb out the window—my partner has him in custody downstairs.

HANRATTY

What are you talking about? Keep your hands up!

FRANK JUNIOR

You think the F.B.I. are the only ones tracking this guy? He's been dabbling in government checks. We've been following a paper trail for months. We almost had him in New York, then in a motel outside D.C. near Dulles airport. Would you mind taking that gun out of my face? It makes me nervous.

HANRATTY

Let me see some identification.

FRANK JUNIOR

Here, take my whole wallet.

(tosses him wallet)

You want my gun, too?

HANRATTY

I didn't expect Secret Service on this.

FRANK JUNIOR

Don't worry about it. What's your name, anyway?

HANRATTY

Hanratty. Carl Hanratty.

FRANK JUNIOR

You mind if I see an ID, Carl? Can't be too careful these days.

HANRATTY

Sure.

(Hanratty shows him his badge)

FRANK JUNIOR

Tough luck, Carl. Five minutes earlier and you would have landed yourself a pretty good collar.

HANRATTY

That's okay, ten seconds later you would have been shot.

(They laugh, then stop laughing)

Hey, listen. Tell me something: What does he look like?

FRANK JUNIOR

He's a handsome son of a bitch.

HANRATTY

I had him figured for an older guy.

FRANK JUNIOR

He is pretty damn old. He must be your age at least.

HANRATTY

I asked for that one!

FRANK JUNIOR

Just do me a favor. Sit tight a minute while I get some of this evidence downstairs. I don't want people walking through my crime scene.

HANRATTY

Sure.

(Frank Junior picks up the MICK machine and heads for the door.)

FRANK JUNIOR

You know, some maid comes in here and starts making the bed. I hate when that happens.

HANRATTY

Wait.

FRANK JUNIOR

(freezes, turns)

What?

HANRATTY

Your wallet.

FRANK JUNIOR

Hang on to it till I come back for the rest of the stuff. I trust you.

HANRATTY

You shouldn't. That was a joke.

FRANK JUNIOR

You got me, Carl.

(Frank Junior smiles at him and goes.)

HANRATTY

Nice guy.

(unable to contain himself)

We got him! I love my job. I love it, I love it, I love it.

(He stops. Thinks a minute. Opens the wallet. Fingers through the ID cards within.)

Frank Taylor. Frank Black. Frank Williams. Frank ~~Hanratty~~ *Dennis*

(The other three agents rush in)

COD

Where is he?

HANRATTY

I had him. He was right there!

BRANTON

What are you talking about?

HANRATTY

I let him convince me he was someone else. Barry Allen from the Secret Service.

DOLLAR

Barry Allen? The Flash?

HANRATTY

What?

DOLLAR

Barry Allen is the alter ego of the Flash.

HANRATTY

Oh, ~~Jesus Christ~~ *Son of Bitch*

DOLLAR

We all make mistakes, sir, it happens to the best of us.

HANRATTY

Not to me. Not to me.

(MUSIC.)

#9-P

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Scene 12

A Phone Booth and the FBI Building, both Washington, DC

#9 - Phil Spector's Favorite Xmas

PARTYGOERS (FEMALE TRIOS)

ANGELS SING THE SOUNDS SUBLIME
LISTEN TO THOSE CHURCHBELLS CHIME
CHRISTMAS IS MY FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR

IN THE SUN WE'LL HAVE SOME FUN
BUT I PREFER THE SNOW
SUMMER WORDS ARE FOR THE BIRDS
'CAUSE ALL I NEED IS 'HO HO HO'

GIRLS

SANTA HOPE YOU'RE
IN YOUR PRIME

TO MAKE THAT MIDNIGHT
CHIMNEY CLIMB
CHRISTMAS IS MY
FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR
CHRISTMAS IS MY
FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR

BOYS

HEY SANTA
YOU'RE IN YOUR PRIME,
YEAH

YEAH IT'S
CHRISTMAS
FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR

FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR

BRANTON

Hanratty, come on. It's Christmas Eve. You're not going to redeem yourself with the boys upstairs by having a miserable holiday.

HANRATTY

You're wrong. It's not Christmas Eve. It's Christmas.

BRANTON

You want me to stay?

HANRATTY

No. Go home. You've got kids.

BRANTON

Merry Christmas, Hanratty

(He goes. Hanratty's phone RINGS. He picks up.)

HANRATTY

This is Hanratty. Merry Christmas.

(Lights on Frank Junior at a pay phone.)

FRANK JUNIOR

Hello, Carl.

HANRATTY

Who is this?

FRANK JUNIOR

Merry Christmas.

HANRATTY

Barry Allen, Secret Service! What do you want?

FRANK JUNIOR

I want to apologize for what happened out in Los Angeles.

HANRATTY

Screw you.

FRANK JUNIOR

Carl, I'm sorry if I made a fool out of you.

HANRATTY

Goddamn it, you don't feel sorry for me. The truth is, I knew it was you. Maybe I didn't pull the trigger but I knew.

FRANK JUNIOR

People only know what you tell them.

HANRATTY

Then tell me something: how did you know I wouldn't look in the wallet?

FRANK JUNIOR

I didn't.

HANRATTY

You're gonna get caught, you know that, don't you? One way or another. Just like Vegas—the house always wins.

FRANK JUNIOR

I didn't think I'd get you in. It's Christmas. I thought maybe you had a family?

#10 – My Favorite Time of Year

HANRATTY

No. No family.

Me ei

(I

Me either.

FRANK JUNIOR

HANRATTY

YEAH, DON'TCHA LOVE THE YULETIDE FUN
THERE'S JOY AND CHEER FOR EVERYONE
I WAIT FOR SANTA WITH A GUN
YES, CHRISTMAS IS MY FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR

FRANK JUNIOR

SOME SUGAR PLUMS I HAVEN'T KISSED
BUT MISTLETOE I MUST RESIST
CAUSE I'M ON ST. CARL'S MOST WANTED LIST

BOTH

YES, CHRISTMAS IS MY FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR

(Lights up on Frank Sr and Paula)

HANRATTY, FRANK JR, FRANK SR, PAULA
AND THERE'S A HOME
WHERE YOU CAN'T GO
AND THERE'S A LIFE THAT'S FULL OF LOVE
YOU USED TO KNOW

HANRATTY

FOR ME IT'S TRUE

FRANK SENIOR

BUT KID, NOT YOU

PAULA

CAUSE YOUR FAMILY'S HERE

FRANK SENIOR and PAULA

YEAH, THEY'RE STILL YOURS TO HOLD
IF YOU...

FRANK SENIOR, PAULA and HANRATTY

COME IN FROM THE COLD

(Lights fade on Frank Senior and Paula.)

HANRATTY

SO IF TOMORROW SANTA'S FLOWN,
THE TREE IS DOWN AND YOU'RE ALONE

(HANRATTY)

I'M ALWAYS HERE RIGHT BY THE PHONE.

FRANK JUNIOR + HANRATTY

YES, CHRISTMAS IS MY FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR.

HANRATTY

Wait a minute. You didn't call to apologize, did you?

FRANK JUNIOR

What do you mean?

HANRATTY

You've got no one else to talk to.

FRANK JUNIOR

(half beat)

I have to go.

HANRATTY

Frank! Wait!

(after a moment)

Frank?

FRANK JUNIOR

I'm still here.

HANRATTY

Sooner or later you'll get tired of running.

FRANK JUNIOR

Sooner or later you'll get tired of chasing me.

HANRATTY

No I won't.

FRANK JUNIOR

Look out the window.

HANRATTY

Why?

FRANK JUNIOR

Just do it.

(He sings.)

I'LL CALL YOU SOON, BUT WHO KNOWS WHEN?

HANRATTY

AND, FRANK, I HOPE WE'LL MEET AGAIN
LIKE WHEN YOU'RE SERVING EIGHT TO TEN

FRANK JUNIOR + HANRATTY

YES, CHRISTMAS IS MY FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR.

ENSEMBLE

ANGELS SING THE SOUNDS SUBLIME
LISTEN TO THOSE CHURCHBELLS CHIME
CHRISTMAS IS MY FAVORITE TIME OF YEAR

(Hanratty sees Frank Junior by the pay phone booth. Frank Junior waves gently and runs off into the night)

HANRATTY

(to himself)

He's a kid.

(to us)

He's a kid.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

Scene 1

The FBI Building, Washington, DC

#11 - *Entr'acte*

(As the Entr'acte ends, we see Hanratty and his three men, huddled in a hallway.)

HANRATTY

Look, it's simple. We know he's a kid. We need to find out who's responsible for the kid. So we check out every runaway teen and missing student in the tri-state area over the past three years.

(A Lovely Lady brings in a stack of computer printouts.)

I pulled a list from the mainframe.

(The Lovely Lady hands him the top page of an accordion-feed computer printout.)

We just go to each address, ask to see a family photo.

(He pulls the paper, which just keeps coming.)

DOLLAR (Voice Over)

How long will that take?

HANRATTY

As long as it takes. Let's go, men.

(Hanratty exits, the long list trailing behind him. The men follow. The last agent stays behind, whipping off his fedora and RayBans to reveal...

...Frank Junior. He waves.)

FRANK JUNIOR

Good luck with that!

#11a - *Intro To Riverbend Apartments*

(turns to us as the Lovely Lady takes his hat and RayBans)

My career as a pilot was pretty much done, and I'd wrung out every bank in the Northeast, so it was time to lay low for a while, live off my savings. I moved to the Riverbend Apartments in Atlanta, Georgia, a real nice complex, full of professionals, the perfect place to keep things quiet.

(ATLANTA DOCTOR enters at a stumbling run, drink in hand.)

ALL PARTY DOCTORS & NURSES

Woo-hoo!

FRANK JUNIOR

I was just there to keep a low profile. No more cons, no more high living, no more lies.

(The ATLANTA DOCTOR approaches Frank Junior as we CONTINUE TO:)

Scene 2

**The Riverbend Apartments
and Atlanta General Hospital, Atlanta**

(The ATLANTA DOCTOR throws an arm around him.)

ATLANTA DOCTOR

So, Frank, what brings you to the Riverbend complex? I thought it was just us doctors and nurses here.

FRANK JUNIOR

(works the problem)

Oh. Well. You know. I'm a doctor.

ATLANTA DOCTOR

What do you do, surgery? Orthopedics?

FRANK JUNIOR

Pediatrics?

ATLANTA DOCTOR

Snot-nosed little kids? You can have 'em. Listen, I'll find out if there's anything open down at Atlanta General. Be great to have you there!

(He goes.)

FRANK JUNIOR

Oh, no, thank you, I — I mean — What was I thinking?

(MUSIC. Several very sexy NURSES appear. Frank Junior looks at them...)

#12 — Doctor's Orders

Oh yeah.

(...then back to us.)

Ladies and gentlemen—nurses.

(The NURSES seduce Frank Junior into the medical profession — dressing him as a doctor in the process.)

NURSE 1

HEY DOCTOR, ARE YOU ON CALL?

I'M NOT FEELING SO WELL AT ALL

I KEPT THINKING ABOUT YA

AS I COULD NOT SLEEP A WINK LAST NIGHT

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(NURSE 1)

I TOSSED AND TURNED THE WHOLE NIGHT LONG
KEPT FEELING LIKE SOMETHING'S WRONG
I NEED A CHECKUP
TO MAKE EVERYTHING ALL RIGHT

ALL NURSES

SO I...

NURSE 1

MADE THIS APPOINTMENT
AND I CLEARED YOUR AFTERNOON

ALL NURSES

YES, I...

NURSE 1

NEED ME A LITTLE "T.L.C."
AND I GOTTA GET SOME SOON...

ALL NURSES

LET ME TELL YA THAT

NURSE 1

MAYBE I NEVER LISTENED GOOD
I NEVER DID THE THINGS I SHOULD
BUT I'M READY
TO TAKE DOCTOR'S ORDERS!

BABY, I NEVER FELT SO BAD
I NEED SOMETHING I NEVER HAD
AND I'M READY...
TO TAKE DOCTOR'S ORDERS!

ALL NURSES

OOH OOH...

(The Nurses turn upstage)

FRANK JUNIOR

How was I going to pull this one off? Then I thought of it, Ben Casey always made it look easy on television.

(BEN CASEY and a BEN CASEY INTERN appear.)

Frank Junior watches as Ben Casey makes a diagnosis ala a TV epsisode)

BEN CASEY

I think what we have here is advanced third-degree encephelomarginalia.
Do you concur, doctor?

BEN CASEY INTERN

Yes, I concur. What do you recommend, Doctor Casey?

BEN CASEY

Let's not jump to any conclusions. We'll run every test we can.

(into camera)

We'll find out what's ailing you, son.

FRANK JUNIOR

(clicks it off, speaks to us)

After the checks and pilots ID, a diploma was easy.

*(He's joined by DOCTOR WANAMAKER - the head of Atlanta General.
He's inspecting a framed document.)*

DOCTOR WANAMAKER

Harvard University! Very impressive, Doctor Connors. And you actually brought in your diploma. And we have a letter of recommendation from your last hospital signed by a Carl Hanratty?

FRANK JUNIOR

My mentor.

DOCTOR WANAMAKER

You're just the perfect candidate.

FRANK JUNIOR

I should mention, the sight of blood makes me kinda, you know...*[nauseous]*

(Wanamaker laughs. Frank Junior laughs)

No, seriously.

DOCTOR WANAMAKER

At the moment, the only thing open is overnight ER supervisor. Beneath a doctor of your qualifications, and you'd be primarily supervising residents and interns, so you wouldn't get much real patient contact—

FRANK JUNIOR

I'll take it.

DOCTOR WANAMAKER

All right then. Welcome aboard.

(He goes, and the nurses come back.)

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NURSE 1

HEY DOCTOR, I NEED REPAIR
I NEED INTENSE, INTENSIVE CARE
I BETTER TAKE HEED

ALL NURSES

OF THE SURGEON GENERALS WARNING

NURSE 1

AND IF YOU'RE TIRED OF LOOKING PALE

NURSES 2 & 3

I'LL BE YOUR FLORENCE NIGHTENGALE

NURSE 1

AND IF ONE WON'T DO

NURSES 2 & 3

THEN PLEASE TAKE TWO

NURSES 1, 2 & 3

AND CALL US IN THE MORNING

ALL

YES, I LIKED PLAYING DOCTOR
WAS MY FAVORITE GAME INDOORS
I STILL LIKE TO PLAY AROUND
I'LL SHOW YOU MINE
IF YOU SHOW ME YOURS

NURSE 2

MAYBE I NEED YOUR REMEDY

DOC, IT'S AN EMERGENCY
SO I'M READY

TO TAKE DOCTOR'S ORDERS

NURSE 3

BABY I NEED THE ANTIDOTE

YOU'RE HIDING UNDER THAT
WHITE LAB COAT
YES I'M READY

NURSES

OOH OOH

READY

DOCTOR'S ORDERS

OOH OOH ...

(NURSE 3)

(NURSES)

TO TAKE DOCTOR'S ORDERS

READY

OOH OOH

(BRENDA pushes her way through the passel of sexy nurses)

BRENDA

Doctor Conners! Doctor Conners!

(Frank Junior turns and sees her and MUSIC CHANGES.)

FRANK JUNIOR

And there she was—in the middle of all those glamazons...she was real. The minute I saw her, I knew. I just knew she was the one. And it didn't hurt that she was the best nurse there. I needed the help.

(Two interns enter, pushing a gurney. Brenda lifts the bloody sheet.)

BRENDA

Doctor Conners! MVA, car versus bike. Should we set it or get a surgical consult?

FRANK JUNIOR

(Caseyesque — showing off for her)

Let's not jump to any conclusions, Nurse Strong. We'll run every test we can.

BRENDA

(leading him to water)

Okay, Doctor Conners, but—

INTERN 1

(interrupting, lifts sheet)

He's got a bone sticking out of his leg.

FRANK JUNIOR

(struggling not to lose it)

Yes...Doctor...I, uh...I...concur! I concur! Just go! Go!

BRENDA

You heard him! Go! Go!

(She ushers them out as Frank Junior recovers, and pursues her.)

FRANK JUNIOR

Wait! Nurse! Not you!

(He tries to follow, but the Sexy Nurses return to block his way.)

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NURSES

OOH-OOH-OOH
OOH-OOH-OOH
AH-AH

NURSE 4

I KNOW WHAT THEY SAY
ABOUT AN APPLE A DAY
TO BE THE STRONGEST GAL IN TOWN
BUT IF AN APPLE A DAY
KEEPS THE DOCTOR AWAY
I'M GONNA BURN THAT
ORCHARD DOWN!

NURSE 3

BABY DON'T STOP UNTIL I'M HEALED

I'VE GOT BLUE CROSS
I'VE GOT BLUE SHIELD
AND I'M READY

TO TAKE DOCTOR'S ORDERS

NURSE 2

BABY, YOU'D BETTER OPERATE

NURSE 1

THEN TO MIAMI TO RECOUPERATE

NURSE 2

YES I'M READY

TO TAKE DOCTOR'S ORDERS

ALL NURSES

TALKING 'BOUT WHAM-BAM
HOT DAMN

NURSE 4

OXYGEN PLEASE,
CAN'T CATCH MY BREATH

DOCTOR YOU GOT THE KISS OF DEATH
AND I'M

NURSES & DOCTORS

KNOW WHAT THEY SAY

OOH...
OOH OOH

GONNA BURN THAT
ORCHARD DOWN!

OOH OOH

READY

DOCTOR'S ORDERS
OOH...

READY

ALL MEN

WHAM BAM
HOT DAMN

NURSES

OOH OOH ...

NURSES 1-4

ENSEMBLE

READY

READY

READY

READY

COME ON, LET'S ROCK

COME ON, LET'S ROCK

STEADY

STEADY

ALL

'CAUSE I'M READY ...
FOR DOCTOR'S ORDERS!

NURSE 4

WOO!

#12a - Doctor's Orders Playoff

*(The doctors and nurses go to party. Frank Junior grabs some shut-eye on a gurney.
Brenda enters.)*

BRENDA

Doctor Conners? Doctor Conners?

FRANK JUNIOR

(wakes with a start)

Oh, I was...uh...I'm not getting a lot of sleep at the apartment these days.

BRENDA

Doctor Conners, do you know which patient gets the O-Negative?

*(She holds up a blood bag, dark red in translucent plastic. Frank Junior takes one look
and turns and clutches his stomach, groaning.)*

Doctor?

(A nurse strides through.)

NURSE

O-negative! O-negative! Where's that O-negative?

*(Brenda holds it up and the nurse grabs it. Maybe Frank Junior looks up just in time to
see it change hands, which sets him off again. Either way, after the Nurse is gone:)*

BRENDA

Are you okay?

FRANK JUNIOR

Sorry...just some bad tuna...at the cafeteria.

BRENDA

Is there anything I can do?

FRANK JUNIOR

You could have coffee with me.

BRENDA

But their coffee's worse than their tuna. Oh!

FRANK JUNIOR

I've tried to make conversation with you four times a day for eleven days and you've barely even said hello.

BRENDA

I'm so sorry, Doctor Connors. Hello.

FRANK JUNIOR

Hello.

BRENDA

(half beat)

Goodbye.

(She moves to go.)

FRANK JUNIOR

Nurse Strong!

BRENDA

I'm sorry, sir. They don't like us to fraternize with the doctors.

FRANK JUNIOR

Pretend I'm not a doctor. Pretend I'm a Pan Am pilot.

BRENDA

Oh, I don't think I could see you as a pilot. A playboy maybe.

FRANK JUNIOR

I'm not really in to all that Riverbend madness. It's just, I don't know, a part I play.

BRENDA

So you're not really a skirt-chasing party animal, you just want people to think you are?

FRANK JUNIOR

Well, yeah. I mean, no. I mean—wait.

BRENDA

Good day, Doctor Conners.

FRANK JUNIOR

You're very serious.

BRENDA

I'm just trying to do a good job, sir.

FRANK JUNIOR

Well, I am too, I'm the youngest doctor here.

BRENDA

Aren't you awfully young to be a doctor?

FRANK JUNIOR

I get that a lot.

BRENDA

I'm the youngest nurse here...

FRANK JUNIOR

And the best nurse we have.

BRENDA

Oh, no one ever listens to me. They're all so confident and sure of themselves and...tall.

FRANK JUNIOR

If you want them to listen, you just have to sound like you know what you're talking about. Act like you have confidence, and pretty soon you will. Act like you're not afraid, and you won't be. Okay?

BRENDA

(smiles)

Okay.

FRANK JUNIOR

Hey—there's a smile.

(Two Interns enter at a run, with a gurney.)

INTERN #2

Doctor Conners, we've got a kitchen accident. Meat slicer. And they can't exactly find the hand...

(Frank Junior takes one look and starts to lose it. Brenda steps up.)

BRENDA

Trauma One. I'll call surgery. Go!

(The

See? Lc

Thank y

Call me

Okay. F

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Oh! Su

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But not
word fer

(The Interns hurry off.)

FRANK JUNIOR

See? Look at you.

BRENDA

Thank you. Doctor Conners.

FRANK JUNIOR

Call me Frank.

BRENDA

Okay. Frank.

(a moment, then she remembers:)

Oh! Surgery!

(She hurries off. Frank Junior watches her go.)

MUSIC. He sings.)

#12b - Live In Living Color Reprise

FRANK JUNIOR

LIVE IN LIVING COLOR
NOW THE PICTURE SEEMS SO CLEAR
SHE'S ALIVE IN LIVING COLOR
SO EXCUSE ME WHILE I DISAPPEAR...

(FRANK JR exits. Hanratty appears opposite, watching him.)

HANRATTY

Sooner or later, they always make a mistake. Sooner or later. Meanwhile, while he was busy with Brenda, we were cracking this thing pretty quickly.

#13 - Don't Be A Stranger

So maybe this is my part of the show ... Sort of a film noir kind of thing. It was hot, even for August. So hot my ass was sticking to the seat of the car like a fly on paper and my suit was my own personal sauna.

(Paula enters, a few years older, with three handsome dancing boys. Hanratty will become the fourth.)

But not as hot as the woman I was about to interview. She gave new meaning to the word *femme fatale*. Too bad she was some poor kid's mother.

Scene 3

The Barnes House and A Bar, New Rochelle

PAULA

I haven't seen Frankie, since he ran away.

I ALWAYS KNEW I'D SEE THIS DAY

I CAN'T SAY IT'S A SHOCK

WHAT'S THAT EXPRESSION? QU'EST-CE QUE C'EST?

HE'S "A CHIP OFF THE OLD BLOCK"

BUT IF YOU SEE HIM

PLEASE PASS ON THIS PLEA

DON'T BE A STRANGER

TELL HIM THAT FOR ME

HANRATTY

If I could just look at a photo...

PAULA

I don't have a recent one. Here...his junior class yearbook...

(One of the Handsome Dancing Men hands her the yearbook. She opens the book up, and Hanratty grabs it.)

HANRATTY

That's him. Heavens to Betsey, that's him.

(reads from yearbook)

Class Treasurer?

PAULA

Is my Frankie in some sort of trouble?

HANRATTY

Ma'am, your son's in a great deal of trouble. He's passing bad checks, forging government documents—

(Paula takes the yearbook back from him and gives it back to one of the Handsome Men.)

PAULA

Half of the kids his age are on dope but you chase after Frankie because he made a little mistake? Tant pis. Tell me how much, I'll write you a check—

HANRATTY

So far it's one-point-four million dollars.

PAULA

Ce n'est pas possible.

HANRATTY

Oh, it's possible. Unlikely, but *possible*.

PAULA

He must be good at this.

HANRATTY

If you were trying to raise a crook, you should be very proud.

PAULA

MY FRANKIE HAD A CLEVER MIND
HE COULD SPEND HOURS ALL ALONE
I WOULDN'T HAVE BEEN SURPRISED TO FIND
HE CHANGED HIS DIAPER ON HIS OWN
COULD I HAVE BEEN THERE MORE?
WELL, C'EST LA VIE
DON'T BE A STRANGER
TELL HIM THAT FOR ME

HANRATTY

You haven't heard from him since you left your husband?

PAULA

I'm to blame. Is that what you're saying?

HANRATTY

I don't do blame, ma'am. I just catch the bad guys.

PAULA

Frankie was the result of a night of passion in a fourth rate hotel in Normandy. Two adults who should have known better. Nobody wins. Least of all Frankie.

THOUGH I TRIED, I COULDN'T HIDE
WHEN LOVE HAD FLOWN AWAY
CHILDREN CLOSE THEIR EYES
BUT STILL THEY SEE
I TOOK A CHANCE, A NEW ROMANCE
IS IT A CRIME TO SAY
I MADE A CHOICE
AND CHOSE WHAT'S BEST FOR ME

HANRATTY

How might I locate your son?

PAULA

Ask his father. He says Frankie writes to him.

HANRATTY

And where can I find his father?

PAULA

Check the bars in town.

HANRATTY

Okay then.

(Split scene: The Barnes living room splits the stage with a dive bar and Frank Senior on a barstool.

Paula continues to dance with the THREE ATTRACTIVE MEN in the background.)

FRANK SENIOR

I USED TO BE A PRINCE TO HER
THIS PRINCE HAS LOST HIS CROWN
I BROUGHT HER LAUGHS, SHE WANTED FUR
NO WONDER LOVE FELL DOWN
ARREST THAT CLOWN WHO SAID
THE BEST THINGS IN LIFE ARE FREE
THEN, DON'T BE A STRANGER
TELL HER THAT FOR ME

(Both parents are isolated in spots)

ONE MORE ROUND AT THE LOST AND FOUND,
THAT'S IF YOU'VE GOT THE DOUGH
HAPPY HOUR IS SUDDENLY LAST CALL

PAULA

MY EYES ARE DRY, I SAID GOODBYE
SO MANY TEARS AGO

BOTH

THE PAST IS JUST A PHOTO ON THE WALL

FRANK SENIOR

I GUESS TO YOU I SEEM A SCHMUCK
WELL, I'LL JUST BIDE MY TIME

PAULA

IN LOVE, ALL'S FAIR

FRANK SENIOR

'CAUSE I BELIEVE THAT LADY LUCK
CAN STILL TURN ON A DIME

PAULA

COMME A LA GUERRE

FRANK SENIOR

AND MAYBE ONE
WILL ONCE AGAIN BE THREE

PAULA

C'EST C'QUE J'AI TOUJOURS DIT

FRANK SENIOR

DON'T BE A STRANGER
TELL THEM THAT FOR ME

PAULA

DON'T BE A STRANGER
TELL HIM THAT FOR ME

BOTH

DON'T BE A STRANGER
TELL THEM THAT FOR ME.

HANRATTY

Do you have any idea where your child is?

FRANK SENIOR

He's always in the air. He's a pilot with Pan Am! What a life!

(He lifts an envelope from the bar, toys with it.)

HANRATTY

He's not a pilot anymore, Mister Abagnale. Never was. He's a counterfeiter and con man.

FRANK SENIOR

I knew that. I just wanted to see what you knew.

(looks Hanratty over)

You expect a father to give up his son.

HANRATTY

Yes. I would expect a father to do that. People get shot in my line of work. Real guns. Real bullets. I'd like to bring him in alive.

FRANK SENIOR

Okay. Here's the truth.

(waves the envelope)

Got a letter from him just today. He joined up. He's over in Viet Nam, serving his country.

HANRATTY

Can I see that letter?

FRANK SENIOR

(shakes his head; puts letter away)

No return address. He's in uniform, risking his life for you and me. Not a bad way to leave his troubles behind, I'd say. He got out of the game at just the right time.

HANRATTY

The game?

FRANK SENIOR

You know, the game. Don't let the bastards get the best of you. Look out for yourself, when the banks and the government and the big boys try to rob you blind.

HANRATTY

Is that what you taught your kid?

FRANK SENIOR

A man should go after what he wants in life.

HANRATTY

A man should face up to what he's done.

(Frank Senior throws back his drink and sings. A standoff, and then they turn back to their drinks. The BARTENDER turns to pour them another.)

Mister Abagnale.

FRANK SENIOR

Please—Frank.

HANRATTY

Frank. Your kid needs you now.

FRANK SENIOR

What can I do for him that he can't do better for himself?

HANRATTY

You can tell him to come in. You can tell him it's time to stop. You may be the only one who can.

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#14 - 1

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FRANK SENIOR

Then I think we're all in trouble, Carl. Hell, the kid used to see me as Frank Sinatra, Jesus Christ, and JFK all rolled into one. I couldn't live up to that. I did the best I could. I told him I loved him—every day.

HANRATTY

Maybe you should've told him not to commit grand larceny.

#14 - Little Boy Be A Man

FRANK SENIOR

Way of the world, Carl. Our fathers screw us up, we turn around and do the same to our kids. It's the eternal cycle.

HANRATTY

Until someone breaks it.

FRANK SENIOR

LITTLE BOY, BE A MAN

YEAH, THAT WAS POP'S ONLY PLAN

(Frank Senior slams his glass on the bar; Hanratty switches glasses, giving Frank Senior the full drink.)

HE NEVER KISSED ME

OR SANG "BABY MINE"

SURE, I'D HAVE LOVED A HUG

BUT HEY, I CAME OUT JUST FINE

AND IF I EVER WOULD CRY

HANRATTY

I bet I can guess what happened next...

FRANK SENIOR

HE'D SMACK THE TEAR FROM OUT MY EYE

HANRATTY

Badda-boom

FRANK SENIOR

HE TOLD ME "GROW UP, KID, YOU'RE NO PETER PAN.

LITTLE BOY, BE A MAN."

(Frank Senior throws back the second drink, and Hanratty signals for the two more.)

HANRATTY

But you want to do your kid better, right?

FRANK SENIOR

You have any kids, Carl?

HANRATTY

I do not.

FRANK SENIOR

Then what the hell do you know about it? I s'pose your father was a prince.

HANRATTY

Yeah, of Darkness.

FRANK SENIOR

Hah!

HANRATTY

LITTLE MAN, GROW SOME BALLS
THAT MOTTO RANG THROUGHOUT THE HALLS
ON MY TENTH BIRTHDAY
HE SHOWED ME A GUN
THEN TOOK ME TO THE CORNFIELDS
AND SAID "OKAY...RUN!"

HIS SENSE OF HUMOR WAS LAME
LUCKY FOR ME, SO WAS HIS AIM!
IF HE HAD SEWN SOME NEEDLEPOINT
TO HANG ON THE WALLS
IT WOULD SAID "LITTLE MAN, GROW SOME BALLS."

(They toast with the new drinks ...)

BOTH

BALLGAMES THAT HE MISSED
NIGHTS HE CAME HOME PISSED
WELL, I DON'T THINK ABOUT THAT ANY LONGER

HANRATTY

NO ONE IN THE BLEACHERS

FRANK SENIOR

FISTFIGHTS WITH MY TEACHERS

BOTH

I'M LIVING PROOF WHAT DOESN'T KILL YA

(BOTH)

MAKES YA STRONGER!

HANRATTY

What say we break the losing streak, Frank? Set the kid straight.

FRANK SENIOR

(thickly)

Aw, the kid's fine.

(pulls the envelope out, waves it)

A pilot! Serving his country!

(slaps the envelope on the bar)

He's doin' fine.

HANRATTY

You're sure about that.

FRANK SENIOR

Ya gotta let 'em go, Carl. Can't hold on forever.

(he sings)

LITTLE MAN, LITTLE ME
THEY COME WITH NO WARRANTY
I TRIED TO FIX IT
BUT WHO WOULD HAVE GUESSED
IT'S HARD TO SAY BUT FATHER

BOTH

DOESN'T ALWAYS KNOW BEST

FRANK SENIOR

SO CARL, WHEN YOU HAVE A KID

HANRATTY

MY EX SAID HEAVEN FORBID

FRANK SENIOR

DO AS I SAY, NOT AS I DID

BOTH

LIKE DAD AFTER DAD AFTER DAD AFTER DAD
SINCE THE WHOLE MESS BEGAN

FRANK SENIOR

YOU DO THE BEST YOU CAN

HANRATTY

LITTLE BOY, BE A MAN

(Hanratty watches Frank Senior waver, sit hard, and pass out cold, head on the bar.

Music switches to "MAN INSIDE THE CLUES"

Hanratty picks up the letter and checks the return address.)

#14a - Hanratty's Reprise

BARTENDER

Anything else for ya?

HANRATTY

Payphone? I need to get to Atlanta.

(pulls out a few bills)

Make sure he gets home, okay?

BARTENDER

Buddy, he is home.

(MUSIC. Hanratty steps outside the bar.)

HANRATTY

I'VE LOOKED INTO SO MANY LIVES
BUT NEVER GOT THIS CLOSE
THE DISTANCE MADE IT EASIER TO SEE
I LIKE TO DO THE JOB AT HAND
AND THEN IT'S "ADIOS"
BUT HERE'S A CASE THAT'S GOT THE BEST OF ME

AN ENVELOPE
WITH HIS ADDRESS
A BRAND NEW SET OF TRACKS
LEADING TO A KID WITH NO ROADS LEFT TO CHOOSE

THERE'S NO ONE LEFT TO SAVE THE DAY
IT'S TIME TO FACE THE FACTS
SO I'LL TAKE THAT RIDE
TO THE BOY INSIDES THE CLUES

(He goes. TRANSITION TO ...)

Scene 4

Frank Jr's Bedroom

(Frank Junior emerges from the covers.)

FRANK JUNIOR

Brenda. Brenda it's okay. Come on.

(Brenda emerges.)

BRENDA

I'm sorry, Frank. I want to. I just—I'm not ready.

FRANK JUNIOR

Brenda, it's all right—we can wait. I'd wait forever for you. I mean, it took a month just to get you to talk to me.

BRENDA

It's not like I don't like you.

FRANK JUNIOR

No, it's fine—I love a challenge.

BRENDA

You could have any nurse here. You know girls from everywhere. You've been to Paris, and Italy, and think of all the beautiful women there must be in Germany. Why me?

FRANK JUNIOR

Because...I love that you work hard and you're good at your job. I love that I can just be myself with you. I love that you always tell the truth. So I can ask you anything, like...why'd you leave New Orleans?

BRENDA

(turns away)

Oh. No reason. Well—I sort of ran away.

FRANK JUNIOR

You ran away! Wow. Why would you do something like that?

BRENDA

I was engaged. To be married. He was the son of my father's law partner, and he wasn't very nice to me, and on the morning of my wedding day I looked at myself in my dress and I realized I didn't want to marry him. And so I left. Home. And I haven't been back since.

FRANK JUNIOR

I'm glad you ran away.

(FRANK JUNIOR)

(reaches for her)

I'll never hurt you.

BRENDA

But you're the Harvard graduate world traveler and I'm just...ordinary.

FRANK JUNIOR

Ordinary is beautiful. I don't need Paris. I don't need a fancy restaurant or a sports car.

(MUSIC.)

#15 - Seven Wonders

All that other stuff was just what I found along way...while I was looking for you.

(Frank sings.)

I'VE SEEN THE SEVEN WONDERS
IF YOU GIVE OR TAKE A FEW
BUT ALL THEM SEVEN WONDERS
WELL, THEY CAN'T COMPARE TO YOU

I'VE BEEN A LOTTA PLACES
YES, I'VE TRAVELED NEAR AND FAR
BUT NOW I KNOW
THAT HOME IS WHERE YOU ARE

NIAGARA FALLS?
A LEAKY FAUCET THAT A PLUMBER OUGHTA FIX
THE PYRAMIDS?
ARE REALLY JUST A DUSTY PILE OF BRICKS.

THE TAJ MAHAL?
A FIXER-UPPER.
THE GRAND CANYON?
JUST A-HOLE.
THE GRAND CANAL IN VENICE?
AN EYE-TALIAN TOILET BOWL.

I'VE SEEN THE SEVEN WONDERS
IF YOU GIVE OR TAKE A FEW

(FRANK JUNIOR)

BUT ALL THEM SEVEN WONDERS
WELL, THEY CAN'T COMPARE TO YOU

I'VE BEEN A LOTTA PLACES
YES, I'VE TRAVELED NEAR AND FAR
BUT NOW I KNOW
THAT HOME IS WHERE YOU ARE.

THE AURORA BORHEALIS?

BRENDA

JUST A NIGHT LIGHT ON THE FRITZ

FRANK JUNIOR

AND STONEHENGE?

BRENDA

JUST A BUNCH OF ROCKS

FRANK JUNIOR

LA BREA'S TAR'S

FRANK JUNIOR & BRENDA

THE PITS.

BRENDA

HOW 'BOUT THE LEANING TOWER OF PISA?

FRANK JUNIOR

LOOKS LIKE SOMETHING UP AND BROKE.

BRENDA

MOUNT RUSHMORE?

FRANK JUNIOR

SOMEONE CLIMB UP THERE AND TELL THEM BOYS A JOKE!
YES, MY TRAVELIN' DAYS ARE OVER
GET THE CHECK, I'LL PAY THE BILL

FRANK JUNIOR & BRENDA

'CAUSE I SEE ALL THE WONDERS
IN YOUR EYES, JUST STANDING STILL.

FRANK JUNIOR

Do you think you could go home again...if you were engaged?

BRENDA

Frank. Come on. Don't tease me.

FRANK JUNIOR

We could go see your parents, tell them we're in love.

BRENDA

My father is very intimidating. You'll change your mind.

FRANK JUNIOR

I won't. We can run away tonight.

BRENDA

We can't just run away. You're the overnight ER supervisor.

FRANK JUNIOR

The clock's ticking, Brenda. I can't—I don't want to be a doctor forever. I want to make a home with you.

(sings)

I'VE BEEN A LOTTA PLACES
BUT I'VE LEARNED NOW NEAR AND FAR
THERE'S NO NEED TO ROAM
'CAUSE HOME IS WHERE YOU ARE

BRENDA

THERE'S NO NEED TO ROAM
'CAUSE HOME IS WHERE YOU ARE

FRANK JUNIOR

YES, NOW I KNOW

FRANK JUNIOR + BRENDA

THAT HOME IS WHERE YOU ARE.

#15a - Seven Wonders to FBI

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Scene 5**Hospital Corridor, Atlanta General**

(MUSIC. In an instant the stage is filled with Nurses, Doctors in Orderlies with Gurneys etc. Frank Jr and Brenda get lost amidst the action. As the stage clears, we reveal Hanratty and his men with Dr Wannamaker. Lights up.)

HANRATTY

Doctor, we're looking for a man who goes by the names of Frank Abagnale, Frank William Abagnale, Frank Taylor, Frank Williams, William Franklin, and William Franklin Williams.

ATLANTA DOCTOR

That's a lot of names.

HANRATTY

(off quick head shakes from Wannamaker)

How about Robert Franklin? Frank Thompson? Frank Meyers? Meyer Williams? William Robertson?

(Branton pulls out a picture of Frank Junior)

BRANTON

Have you seen a man who looked like this?

ATLANTA DOCTOR

Maybe... But that man's a pilot.

HANRATTY

He's not a pilot.

ATLANTA DOCTOR

He looks like a pilot.

HANRATTY

He's not a pilot.

ATLANTA DOCTOR

So is he a doctor?

HANRATTY

Wait—he's a doctor?

ATLANTA DOCTOR

Are you asking me or telling me?

HANRATTY

Did he say he's a doctor?

ATLANTA DOCTOR

Do you have any idea who you're looking for?

(Branton pulls out Frank Junior's yearbook photo.)

BRANTON

Frank William Abagnale Junior.

DOLLAR

A.K.A. Frank Williams, Frank Taylor, Frank—

ALL AGENTS

Shut up, Dollar.

ATLANTA DOCTOR

You know, we did have a Frank Conners.

COD

Frank Collins?

ATLANTA DOCTOR

Frank Conners.

COD

Frank Conners.

HANRATTY

Wait—so who's Frank Collins?

ATLANTA DOCTOR

You tell me, I don't know.

HANRATTY

Frank Conners. Looked like this?

ATLANTA DOCTOR

Without the uniform. Ran off with a nurse. Brenda something. Don't know where. Too bad—good doctor. Turned in all his paperwork on time.

HANRATTY

You let this man operate on patients?

ATLANTA DOCTOR

Oh, no. He just supervised the ER.

HANRATTY

For the love of—Doc, you ever go in to take out an appendix and come out with something else?

Once

Let's

(M.

Th

ATLANTA DOCTOR

Once or twice. Why?

HANRATTY

Let's go.

(MUSIC: A vaudeville out. Hanratty and men leave. Lights change.)

Transition to:

Scene 6: The Strong House, New Orleans

(As the Strong Family Dining/Living room forms around them, Frank Junior and Carol Strong have a moment. Brenda and her father, Roger Strong enter a few steps behind and take their seats at the dinner table)

#15b - Intro to Strong Family

CAROL STRONG

Family is important to us, Dr. Connors. You might say it's everything. Brenda's great grandmother, Anna Mae Lulu Jean Abernathy, was married in the front parlor to her great grandfather, Jean Paul David Abraham Fort, f-o-r-t, which is French for "strong". We're an old New Orleans family with just a dab of Jewish. How else do you explain the Abraham? Brenda is our only child. We are very particular about who she brings home.

BRENDA

So is Brenda, mother.

(Frank Jr and Carol are seated)

ROGER

So, before Atlanta, you were in California?

FRANK JUNIOR

Yes, sir. Death Valley Children's Hospital.

ROGER

They have a Children's Hospital in Death Valley?

FRANK JUNIOR

Yes, sir. Right behind the Macy's.

CAROL

Well goddamn and gumbo, Brenda, I think you landed one this time. Much better than that ratty little Delacroix boy. This one's a hunky hunk of you-betcha.

BRENDA

Mother.

ROGER

Doctor Connors. Do you come from a large family?

FRANK JUNIOR

Please, sir, call me Frank. I'm an only child, but I hope to have lots of kids. Family is the most important thing.

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CAROL

Ding ding! Correct answer. But now the make-or-break round. Don't lie to me, now. Are you. A Lutheran?

FRANK JUNIOR

Why, yes, I am a Lutheran.

ROGER

Well then, Frank, would you like to say grace?

(off Frank Junior's hesitation:)

Unless you're not comfortable.

FRANK JUNIOR

Oh, no, absolutely.

(folds hands, bows head, thinks)

Two little mice fell into a bucket of cream. The first mouse quickly gave up and drowned but the second mouse, he struggled so hard that he eventually churned that cream into butter and he walked out. Amen.

ROGER & BRENDA

Amen.

CAROL

Amen and God damn! That was just beautiful. Where did you learn that, you pious piece of cutie-pie?

FRANK JUNIOR

The, ah, First Lutheran Church of Death Valley.

ROGER

Frank, have you decided which hospital you want to work at here in New Orleans?

FRANK JUNIOR

Well, to be quite honest, I'm thinking about getting back into law

ROGER

Are you a doctor or a lawyer?

FRANK JUNIOR

Before I went to medical school, I passed the bar in California. I practiced law for one year, then I decided, why not try my hand at pediatrics.

BRENDA

You're just full of surprises.

FRANK JUNIOR

(a look to us: he's surprised himself)

Yes I am

ROGER

Awfully young to be a lawyer, aren't you?

FRANK

I get that a lot.

CAROL

Sakes alive, the yummy Yankee is a doctor and a lawyer! Oh, Brenda, darlin', you hit the jackpot with this one!

ROGER

Where did you go to law school? Harvard, Yale, Columbia...?

FRANK JUNIOR

Berkeley.

BRENDA & CAROL

Berkeley!

BRENDA

That's where daddy went!

FRANK JUNIOR

Oh! Wow. Fantastic.

ROGER

So, Frank. Was that snake Hollingsworth still teaching there when you went through Berkeley?

FRANK JUNIOR

Hollingsworth...yes. Grumpy old Hollingsworth, right? I tell ya, meaner than ever.

ROGER

And that dog of his? Tell me Frank, what was the name of his little dog?

FRANK JUNIOR

(works the problem, then:)

I'm sorry. The dog was dead when I got there.

ROGER

How unfortunate. A doctor, a lawyer, a Lutheran. So what are you, Frank? 'Cause I think you're about to ask my daughter's hand in marriage, and I have a right to know.

FRANK JUNIOR

Know what, sir?

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BRENDA & CAROL

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FRANK JUNIOR

Know what, sir?

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Is it:

ROGER

The truth. What are you doing here? What is a man of your accomplishments doing with Brenda?

FRANK JUNIOR

Brenda's the best girl I've ever known, sir.

ROGER

But who are you Frank? If you want my blessing...If you want my daughter...I'd like to hear the truth from you now.

FRANK JUNIOR

The truth? The truth, sir...is...The truth is I'm not a lawyer. I'm not a doctor. I'm nothing, really. I'm just a kid who's in love with your daughter.

ROGER

No. I know what you are.

(pause)

You're a romantic.

FRANK JUNIOR

I am?

ROGER

Yes you are. Men like us are nothing without the women we love.

FRANK JUNIOR

Well goddamn and gumbo! May I hug you?

(All laugh.)

BRENDA

Oh, Frank!

(Brenda and Frank kiss, at length. Roger clears his throat to no avail. Finally, Carol jumps up.)

CAROL

Oh, Daddy!

ROGER

Oh, Mommy!

CAROL

Would you look at the time!

ROGER

Is it seven-thirty already?

BRENDA

Is it time for Mitch?

FRANK JUNIOR

Mitch, who's Mitch?

ROGER

Mitch Miller

#16 - (Our) Family Tree

CAROL, ROGER & BRENDA

And the Sing Along Gang!

(They all head for the couch and click the TV on.)

ROGER

Take it, Mother.

(PROJECTIONS of The Strong Family Singers "singing" along as Carol sings.)

CAROL

I FEEL A MIGHTY QUAKE
THE SOUTH BEGINS TO SHAKE
UNDER OUR FAMILY TREE

THE LEAVES BEGIN TO BLOW
GONE WITH THE WIND THEY GO
ALL THROUGH OUR FAMILY TREE

UP TOP MAGNOLIAS BLOOM
THEY SPREAD THEIR SWEET PERFUME
FOR THIS ANCESTRAL JUBILEE

NOW EVERY BOUGH MUST PULL ITS WEIGHT
IT'S TIME TO PRUNE AND PROPAGATE
SO WELCOME TO OUR FAMILY TREE

Come on Daddy!

ROGER

Oh no I coul—alright then I will!

I HEAR

A SEEL

INSIDE

A TWI

FROM

TO JOI

AND I

HE GI

A DIX

Alr

Sir,
mlt
yot

Yes

ROGER

I HEAR THE DOGWOOD'S BARK

A SEED'S BEGUN TO SPARK

INSIDE OUR FAMILY TREE
A TWIG BEGINS TO POKE
FROM OUT THAT MIGHTY OAK
TO JOIN THE JAMBOREE

ROGER & LADIES

AND LIKE A SLIDE TROMBONE

HE GLIDES OUT FULLY GROWN

A DIXIELAND R.S.V.P.

CAROL

RUFF RUFF!

TSSST

MMM

MMM

JAMBOREE

MEN

SAVE SOME OF THAT GUMBO FOR ME

CAROL

WA-WAH

WA-WA-WA-WAH

BOP BU BOP BU BOP BU BOW

ROGER

AND NO ONE MINDS AN EXTRA LIMB

CAROL

ESPECIALLY WHEN IT LOOKS LIKE HIM

ROGER + CAROL

SO WELCOME TO OUR FAMILY TREE

ROGER

Alright Frank, ask that question you came here to ask.

FRANK JUNIOR

Sir, How soon can I take the bar exam in Louisiana? And, Brenda. I've made a lot of mistakes in the past, but I wouldn't change a single one, because they all led me to you. Brenda Strong, will you marry me?

BRENDA

Yes Frank Connors, I will marry you.

STRONG FAMILY SINGERS

WOO!

FRANK JUNIOR

I'LL GIVE A REBEL YELL
TO EVERY SOUTHERN BELLE
UNDER OUR FAMILY TREE

I'LL SWING THE SECOND LINE
WHEN OUR TWO CLANS COMBINE
FOR SOME BIG

+ ALL

EASY HARMONY

FRANK JUNIOR

TRUMPETS BEGIN TO SHOUT

STRONG FAMILY

TO WELCOME OUR NEW SPROUT

FRANK JUNIOR

YOU'VE CHARMED THIS YANKEE REFUGEE

STRONG FAMILY

WE'RE ALL SO LUSH AND OVERGROWN

FRANK JUNIOR

NOW I KNOW I'LL NEVER BE ALONE

STRONGS

WE'RE GLAD YOU CLIMBED OUR

+ FRANK JUNIOR

FAMILY TREE

STRONGS

YOUR LOVE HAS RAISED THE BAR

I'M SWINGING ON A STAR

FAMILY SINGERS

BA BA BA BA BOP WOW!

DOO WOW!

DOO WO!

FRANK JUNIOR

FOR THAT WHO NEEDS A LAW DEGREE?!

GIRLS

THE TREES THAT BEAR THE RIPEST FRUITS

BOYS

ARE TREES THAT HAVE THE DEEPEST ROOTS SO

ALL

SO WELCOME TO OUR FAMILY...

WELCOME TO OUR FAMILY...

WELCOME TO OUR FAMILY TREE!

FRANK JUNIOR

Look out old Frankie is home!

ALL

YEAH!!!

(After applause:

MUSIC. Roger takes Carol and they dance close. Much as Frank Senior and Paula danced at the top of the show. Frank Junior watches Roger and Carol dance. Brenda helps Frank Junior on with a winter coat and scarf. He gives her a kiss, and as Roger and Carol dance off we TRANSITION TO:)

#16a - Transition To Bar

Scene 7

Dive Bar, New Rochelle

*(Frank Senior, in a postal uniform, at the bar, a crusty old BARTENDER behind it.
Frank Junior enters.)*

FRANK JUNIOR

Dad.

FRANK SENIOR

(turns, doesn't go to him)

What are you doing here?

FRANK JUNIOR

I—I came to see you. What are you doing dressed like that?

FRANK SENIOR

I took a job. A government job. I'm beating them at their own game. I'm a government employee—you see how beautiful that is? You got a good lawyer?

FRANK JUNIOR

Well, I sort of am a lawyer now.

FRANK SENIOR

Look at this letter. The I.R.S. wants more. They ate the cake. Now they want the crumbs. You know what? I'll make them chase me. For the rest of their lives.

(looks at Frank Junior)

I had an FBI agent come see me.

FRANK JUNIOR

Mister Hanratty.

FRANK SENIOR

You got their number, son. The United States government, champ. Running for the hills.

FRANK JUNIOR

Dad. It's over. I'm gonna stop now.

FRANK SENIOR

They're never gonna catch you, Frank. Why would you stop?

FRANK JUNIOR

I'm settling down. I'm going to raise a family.

(reaches into his coat, pulls out an invitation)

(FRANK JUNIOR)

I came here to give you this. It's an invitation to an engagement party. Daddy, I'm getting married. Can you believe that? I'm getting married. I've got two tickets for you and mom, first-class, and the wedding—

FRANK SENIOR

Why would you do that? You're on top of the world.

FRANK JUNIOR

I'm changing my life, Dad. And you won't have to worry about anything anymore. The house, the Cadillac, I'm going to get it all back. Everything they took from us. And Mom will see—

FRANK SENIOR

Your mother's remarried. To my friend Jack Barnes. They have a house on Long Island.

FRANK JUNIOR

Why would she do that?

FRANK SENIOR

Don't get married, Frankie.

FRANK JUNIOR

But—why would she do that to us?

FRANK SENIOR

There's no us anymore. Listen to me. I'm your father.

FRANK JUNIOR

Then tell me to stop.

FRANK SENIOR

Why would I tell you to stop?

FRANK JUNIOR

Because you're my father.

FRANK SENIOR

You can't stop. You're on a winning streak. You gotta ride that, baby. Ride it!

(as Frank Junior begins to back away.)

You're an Abagnale! C'mon, sing it with me!

(a cappella, he sings:)

THEY KNEW THE KEY TO LIFE
IS THAT IT'S WHA' CHA DREAM

(Frank Jr. pushes him away and exits.)

(FRANK SENIOR)

Come on, sing it with me!

AND MAKE BUTTER OUT OF CREAM
JUST MAKE BUTTER ...

(speaks, almost inaudibly, and almost in darkness:)

Frankie.

(Lights out. Then...

#16b - Phone Call / Brenda's Room

Suddenly, a jangly phone RING pierces the darkness. Frank Junior steps into one spot, Hanratty into another. Both on the phone.)

HANRATTY

Well, well, Doctor Connors. What do you want?

FRANK JUNIOR

I want it to be over. I'm getting married. I'm settling down. I'm going to have a family.

HANRATTY

You've stolen almost two million dollars. You think we can just call that a wedding present? This is not something you can walk away from, Frank. You will be caught. You will go to prison.

FRANK JUNIOR

Please let me stop, Carl. Please.

HANRATTY

You're scared because I'm getting close. I know you rented that car in Shreveport. The hotel in Lake Charles. You're scared. And you're tired.

FRANK JUNIOR

I'm getting married, Carl. I met the girl of my dreams. This is all over.

HANRATTY

And does she know the truth? About who you are?

FRANK JUNIOR

She loves me for who I really am.

HANRATTY

A crook who's about to be caught.

FRANK JUNIOR

Goodbye Carl.

(A click and the line is dead. Hanratty hangs up, but Frank Junior stands stock still in his spot, handset held to his chest. Branton joins Hanratty).

HANRATTY

Get all the Louisiana papers, last two months. Look for an engagement notice. Frank Conners.

BRANTON

He would've changed his name by now.

HANRATTY

Can't. She knows him as Frank Conners. He loses the name, he loses the girl. Sooner or later, sooner or later! They all make a mistake.

(MUSIC.

And TRANSITION TO:)

Scene 8

Brenda's Bedroom, Strong House, New Orleans

(Frank Junior madly stuffing his suitcase. Brenda sweeps in, in a party dress.)

BRENDA

Frank, where should I put these? They're checks, engagement gifts from Daddy's friends—

(breaks off, sees what he's doing:)

What're you doing? Everyone's downstairs waiting to meet the groom-to-be.

FRANK JUNIOR

I have to leave.

BRENDA

What?

FRANK JUNIOR

Brenda, you love me, right? I mean, you love me no matter what?

BRENDA

Well—of course. Frank, what's going on?

FRANK JUNIOR

You'd love me whether I was sick, or whether I was poor, or whether I had a different name?

(He opens a suitcase and it's full of money.)

BRENDA

Frank, where'd you get all that money?

FRANK JUNIOR

Brenda, listen to me. A name—what's a name, right? It doesn't matter. My name is Frank Connors, right? That's who I am with you. But we all have secrets. Sometimes when I travel, I use the name Frank Taylor. That's my secret.

BRENDA

Frank, what are you talking about? Why are you saying all this?

FRANK JUNIOR

I don't want to lie to you anymore. I'm not a doctor. I never went to medical school. I'm not a lawyer, or a Harvard graduate, or a Berkeley graduate, or a, a Lutheran. I ran away from home two years ago when I was sixteen.

BRENDA

Frank... You're not a Lutheran?

(We hear)

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Frank!

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Frank

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(We hear the sound of sirens in the distance)

FRANK JUNIOR

Here's what we're gonna do. In two days, you're gonna meet me at Miami International Airport, all right? You're going to take this money, leave the house after your parents go to sleep, you're going to take a taxi cab, give the driver this money and tell him to drive all through the night. Okay? And you're not going to tell anyone.

BRENDA

Frank, I can't do that. I'll be too afraid.

FRANK JUNIOR

You know you can do this. I told you before—act like you're brave, and you will be.

(He grabs the suitcase to go.)

BRENDA

Frank! Please. Before you go. Please tell me your name.

FRANK JUNIOR

My name. Is Frank. William. Abagnale. Junior.

BRENDA

I love you, Frank.

FRANK JUNIOR

I love you too.

(They kiss. He pulls away gently.)

I have to go now.

BRENDA

Frank—

FRANK JUNIOR

Shh. No time for goodbyes. I'll see you soon.

(He turns to go, but she pulls him back.)

BRENDA

I don't think I can do this alone.

FRANK JUNIOR

I know you can. You have to.

(He kisses her again and slips out the window. We hear shouts outside the door then...Carol, Roger, and Hanratty enter.)

CAROL

(offstage)

Brenda!

ROGER

Brenda!

BRANTON

Is he here?

HANRATTY

Brenda. Where is he?

BRENDA

He's gone.

HANRATTY

Where'd he go?

(gets no answer, then, gently:)

Listen to me, Brenda, sweetheart, this could end very badly. We've got men after him in every state. Men who shoot to kill. You have to tell me where he is.

BRENDA

I can't.

(Cod bursts in.)

COD

Hanratty. Three of the guests saw someone leaving out the back.

HANRATTY

(to Brenda, moving to go)

Don't go anywhere.

(Hanratty, Carol, and Cod go.)

ROGER

Brenda, darling, if you love him, you'll do the right thing. Young Lady!

(Roger shakes his head and exits.)

#17 - Fly, Fly Away

WHEN I WAS A CHILD

MY EYES WERE CLEAR, I SAW THE GOOD SIDE

MEN
WER
ANC

BUT
GAV

(BRENDA)

THAT'S THE KIND OF SECOND SIGHT
THAT DOESN'T LAST TOO LONG

BUT WHEN I WAS LOST
I HEARD A VOICE THAT BROUGHT ME HEALING
THAT'S THE KIND OF SPECIAL HOPE
HE BROUGHT ME WITH HIS SONG

PEOPLE ONLY SAW THE DOCTOR,
LAWYER, INDIAN CHIEF
BUT HE WAS JUST
A LONELY LITTLE BOY TO ME.

WITH HIS SWEET AND GENTLE TOUCH,
HE SURE UNLOCKED MY SOUL
SO IN RETURN,
I SURELY WANT TO HELP TO SET HIM FREE...

YEAH, NOW I WANNA SEE HIM
FLY...FLY...
I'LL BE YOUR ALIBI MY BABY
FLY, FLY, FLY AWAY...

I DIDN'T GET TO SAY GOODBYE, GOODBYE
NO NEED TO TELL ME WHY MY BABY
MAYBE IT'S BECAUSE
YOU'LL FLY BACK HOME TO ME ONE DAY

THREE WOMEN

OOH-OOH. MMM-MMM.
OOH-OOH. AH-AH

BRENDA

MEN WHO THEY CALL REAL
WERE REALLY FAKES
AND LEFT ME NOTHING

BUT THIS MAN THEY CALL A FAKE
GAVE ME SOMETHING REAL

THREE WOMEN

MMM-MMM-MMM

AH. AH-AH.
MMM-MMM.

(BRENDA)

I'VE KNOWN CRUEL, CRUEL MEN
WITH CHRISTIAN NAMES
WHO TAUGHT ME MANNERS

BUT THIS MAN WITHOUT A NAME
TAUGHT ME HOW TO FEEL

THEY ONLY SAW THE MAGIC TRICKS
THE SMOKE AND MIRRORS

WAS I THE ONLY ONE
TO EVER SEE THE BOY

SO NOW THEY WANNA
CLIP HIS PRECIOUS WINGS
AND BRING HIM DOWN

BUT IN HIS HEART AND SOUL'S
THE KIND OF GOOD THEY
CAN'T DESTROY

YEAH, NOW I WANNA SEE HIM
FLY...
FLY...
I'LL BE YOUR ALIBI MY BABY
FLY, FLY, FLY AWAY...

WE DIDN'T GET TO SAY GOODBYE,
GOODBYE
NO NEED TO TELL ME WHY MY BABY
MAYBE IT'S BECAUSE
YOU'LL FLY BACK HOME TO ME
ONE DAY

(Brenda's bedroom goes away.)

BABY WHEN YOU'RE IN THE CLOUDS
PLEASE KEEP A LOOKOUT
MAYBE DARLING FIND A HIDEAWAY

(THREE WOMEN)

OOH-OOH
OOH-OOH
AAH-OOH-OOH.

OOH-OOH-OOH.
OOH ...

BOY.
AAH-AAH.

AHH-AHH
BRING HIM DOWN
AHH-AHH

OOH-OOH-OOH.

FLY
FLY AWAY

GOODBYE
MAYBE IT'S BECAUSE

OOH-OOH. AAH.

AAH-AAH.
OOH-OOH.
AAH.

FOR
YOU

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FLY.
I'LL
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(BRENDA)

FOR YOU AND I
YOU AND I

NOW I'LL SEE HIM
FLY...FLY...
I'LL BE YOUR ALIBI MY BABY
FLY, FLY, FLY AWAY...

WE DIDN'T GET TO SAY GOODBYE,
GOODBYE
NO NEED TO TELL ME WHY MY BABY
MAYBE IT'S BECAUSE
YOU'LL FLY BACK HOME TO ME ONE DAY

MAYBE IT'S BECAUSE
YOU'LL FLY BACK HOME TO ME ONE DAY

MAYBE IT'S BECAUSE
YOU'LL FLY BACK HOME TO ME ONE DAY

AND I'LL BE WAITING FOR YOU THERE
YOU WILL FLY BACK HOME TO ME ONE DAY.

(THREE WOMEN)

YOU AND I.

OOH...

FLY...FLY...

FLY, FLY, FLY AWAY...

GOODBYE

OOH-OOH.

OOH-OOH.

AAH-AAH

AAH-AAH. OOH.

OOH-OOH-OOH-OOH.

OOH-OOH-OOH.

FLY, FLY AWAY.

(Lights to black. In black, we hear the deafening roar a jet plane taking off.)

Scene 9

Miami International Airport

(Lights on the same airport scene we saw at rise:

A deafening SHOT stops everyone in their tracks. Frank JR is center with his open suitcase on the ground and his hands in the air. The Passengers all stare.)

#18 - Goodbye

FRANK JUNIOR

That was close you could hurt someone.

HANRATTY

Come on, Frank. I'd rather take you alive than dead.

FRANK JUNIOR

Can I at least make a statement first?

HANRATTY

At the airport? No. You're not putting on a show for these people.

FRANK JUNIOR

A show?

BRENDA

Frank!

(She breaks and runs towards him. The agents stop her before she gets to him)

FRANK JUNIOR

Brenda!

HANRATTY

Brenda was your big mistake. We followed her right to you.

BRENDA

Frank, I'm sorry. I tried.

FRANK JUNIOR

It's okay. I understand.

BRENDA

Frank—I love you.

HANRATTY

All right, get her out of here. Cod, get everyone out of here.

BRANTON

Hanratty don't let him—

HANRATTY

I got this. Just go.

(And they do.)

I'm sorry, Frank. It's time to give up.

FRANK JUNIOR

IT'S MY HAPPY ENDING.

HANRATTY

That's not true, Frank.

FRANK JUNIOR

NOW IT'S TIME TO SAY GOODNIGHT—
WE CAN STOP PRETENDING.
TELL THE SPOTLIGHT MAN TURN OFF MY LIGHT.

'CAUSE THE SHOW IS DONE NOW
AND IT'S TIME TO LEAVE THE STAGE.
YEAH, THE GOOD GUYS WON NOW
AND THE BAND HAS NO MORE SONGS TO PLAY
IT'S A HAPPY ENDING SO I'LL SAY

GOODBYE
GOODBYE TO ALL THE MAKE BELIEVE
GOODBYE
THERE'S NO MORE MAGIC UP MY SLEEVE

THERE'S NOTHING LEFT TO ACT UP HERE
I'LL TAKE MY BOW AND DISAPPEAR
NO QUESTIONS LEFT FOR ANSWERING
THERE'S ONLY ONE WORD LEFT TO SING
GOODBYE

HANRATTY

You can't just walk away from from this. You're wanted on every continent.

FRANK JUNIOR

IT'S A HAPPY ENDING
TO THE GREATEST SHOW ON EARTH.

(FRANK JUNIOR)

NOW THE CURTAIN'S DESCENDING
AND I HOPE YOU GOT YOUR MONEY'S WORTH
GONNA STOP THE SHOW NOW
'CAUSE I WANNA LEAVE ON TOP
SO GET UP AND GO NOW
'CAUSE THERE'S NOTHING LEFT INSIDE MY HEAD
EVERYTHING THAT'S LEFT TO SAY'S BEEN SAID

BUT GOODBYE
GOODBYE TO ALL THE SONG AND DANCE
GOODBYE
OFFSTAGE I STAND A BETTER CHANCE

THE SHOW IS THROUGH, THE PART'S BEEN PLAYED
NO STANDING IN THE WINGS AFRAID
NO VIOLINS OR PHONY TEARS
THE WORD THAT'S MUSIC TO MY EARS
IS GOODBYE
GOODBYE
GOODBYE
GOODBYE

I'M NOT AFRAID OF STOPPING
THIS END COULD BE MY START
I WANNA LIVE A LIFE
AND NOT JUST PLAY A PART

I'LL WALK INTO THE SUNSET
I'LL SAIL ACROSS THE SEA
THE FINAL WORD
THE LAST YOU'LL HEAR OF ME
OF ME

IS GOODBYE
GOODBYE TO EVERY NIGHT ALONE
GOODBYE
GOODBYE TO LIVES THAT I DON'T OWN
I'M TIRED OF LIVING ON A STAGE
A LIFE THAT'S ONLY ON THE PAGE

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(FRANK JUNIOR)

THE EMPTY LIVES ARE IN THE PAST
I'VE TRIED BEFORE, BUT HERE'S THE LAST
GOODBYE
GOODBYE
GOODBYE
GOODBYE!

I don't understand. You're still here.

HANRATTY

Yup. And you're under arrest. It doesn't just end because you want it to. You don't walk out of your life as if it never happened. You don't get to do that.

FRANK JUNIOR

My dad's waiting for me up north. We're gonna move back to New Rochelle, we're gonna open up the store--

HANRATTY

Your dad's dead, Frank. I'm sorry to be the one to tell you. Grand Central Station-- he fell down some stairs and broke his neck.

FRANK JUNIOR

No!

HANRATTY

The police report said he'd been drinking.

FRANK JUNIOR

You're lying to me.

HANRATTY

I don't lie.

FRANK JUNIOR

No. You don't get to say that. That's not how this ends.

HANRATTY

I'm sorry. I'm sorry, Frank. Now it's time to face up to what you've done. It's time to stop.

FRANK JUNIOR

What if I don't know how?

HANRATTY

You don't have a choice.

FRANK JUNIOR

I could go. I could run, right now.

HANRATTY

I know, but you won't.

FRANK JUNIOR

How do you know?

HANRATTY

Because you're tired of running. Because it won't bring you dad back.

FRANK JUNIOR

I just wanted to get him back on his feet.

HANRATTY

I know. Listen, come with me. You do your time, pay your debt to society and we'll get you out early. You'll come work at the Bureau.

FRANK JUNIOR

At the FBI?

HANRATTY

We need your know-how. We're years behind on forgery and counterfeiting, and now with these computers and credit cards coming in, it's only going to get worse ...

FRANK JUNIOR

The FBI? Really? You mean you'll lock me up, then let me out and pay me to do what you locked me up for?

HANRATTY

That's what I said.

FRANK JUNIOR

Would I get a badge?

HANRATTY

Even better. You'll get a life.

FRANK JUNIOR

But why would you want to help me?

HANRATTY

(Pause.)

Because I'm the only one who can.

(Pause.)

(Hanratty cuffs Frank Jr.)

FRANK JUNIOR

Thanks for not giving up on me, Mister Hanratty. You're pretty cool.

(Frank)

Thank y

(Hanratty)

So how

Your w

(MURPHY)

#19 - Still

(Frank, Jr. suddenly hugs Hanratty)

HANRATTY

Thank you. Nobody ever said that about me before.

(Hanratty slowly raises his arms to return the hug)

FRANK JUNIOR

So how do we end this?

HANRATTY

Your way.

(MUSIC.)

#19 - Stuck Together (Strange But True)

STOP YOUR SOBBIN' KID, BEFORE I SHOOT.
YOUR NOSE IS RUNNING ON MY ONLY SUIT.
WHO'D'AVE THOUGHT I'D SHARE THIS DANCE WITH YOU
LOOKS LIKE WE'RE STUCK TOGETHER
WHICH IS STRANGE BUT TRUE.

FRANK JUNIOR

(wipes his eyes, musters a smile)

GUESS YOU CAUGHT ME, NOW THE CHASE IS DONE.
YOU MUST ADMIT I GAVE YOU QUITE THE RUN.
MISTER TORTOISE - HERE'S YOUR RABBIT STEW.
LOOKS LIKE WE'RE STUCK TOGETHER
WHICH IS STRANGE BUT TRUE.

HANRATTY

TELL MISTER RIPLEY AT "BELIEVE IT OR NOT"

HANRATTY & FRANK JUNIOR

THE SHOW IS OVER AND HE'S ALL THAT I GOT.

HANRATTY

HARD TO BELIEVE IT BUT WE'RE TYING THE KNOT TODAY

FRANK JUNIOR

THAT'S OKAY.

HANRATTY

FRANK, THANK YOUR PUBLIC WHILE YOU'RE STILL IN YOUR PRIME.
THEY WON'T BE SEEING YOU FOR QUITE A LONG TIME.

(HANRATTY)

AND AFTER YOU'VE PAID FOR YOUR LIFE OF CRIME
WELL KID WE'LL SEE WHAT GOOD BEHAVIOR CAN DO.

HANRATTY & FRANK JUNIOR

'TIL THEN WE'RE STUCK TOGETHER
WHICH IS STRANGE BUT TRUE.

(Frank Junior turns to us.)

HANRATTY

Okay, Frank. How'd you do it? How'd you cheat on the Louisiana bar exam?

FRANK JUNIOR

I didn't cheat. I studied.

HANRATTY

No! I hate you.

FRANK JUNIOR

Agent Hanratty turned out to be as good as his word.

HANRATTY

Frank was sentenced to fifteen years in prison but was paroled after seven for good behavior.

FRANK JUNIOR

I set up my own security company and would pay back every bad check I passed.

CHERYL ANN

The bastard never paid me back.

HANRATTY

Not now, Cheryl Ann. Let it go.

FRANK JUNIOR

Brenda married a real doctor and lived happily ever after.

HANRATTY

Frank and I became good friends.

FRANK JUNIOR

He even agreed to be the godfather to my kids. True story.

(MUSIC BUILDS as the full company enters.)

FRANK JUNIOR, HANRATTY + FULL COMPANY

HEY, MISTER LAWYER, MISTER TWO-ON-THE-AISLE—
YOU NEVER CAN PREDICT WHEN FORTUNE MAY SMILE.

HANRATTY

IN FACT, I THINK I'M GONNA BREAK WITH TRADITION.
AND TELL J. EDGAR HOOVER, "BABY I'VE GONE FISHIN'!"

FRANK JUNIOR

IF YOU HAD READ THIS, YOU'D HAVE SAID "NO WAY!"
I ALMOST MADE IT LOOK LIKE CRIME DOES PAY
THERE'S LOTS OF FOLKS THAT I MISS EVERYDAY

(He looks around at all the faces from his past ~ the full company.)

FRANK JUNIOR & HANRATTY

BUT NOW A NEW DUET HAS MADE ITS DEBUT
AND NOW WE'RE STUCK TOGETHER

COMPANY

OH YEAH!

BOTH

IN AND OUT OF LUCK TOGETHER!

COMPANY

OH YEAH!

BOTH

I'M GLAD WE'RE STUCK TOGETHER
WHICH IS STRANGE BUT TRUE.

FRANK JUNIOR

YOUR JUNIOR PARTNER CAME THROUGH.

HANRATTY

A SIMPLE CASE OF MONKEY SEE, MONKEY DO.

FRANK JUNIOR

I'M GLAD TO BE ON YOUR TEAM.

HANRATTY

LET'S MAKE SOME BUTTER OUT OF CREAM!

FRANK JUNIOR

SHA-DOO-BAH DWEE-LEEYAH DO-BAH
DWEE-LE-YAH DOO-BOP!

ENSEMBLE

YEAH!

(The curtain falls.)

THE END

#20 - Bows

#21 - Exit Music